OptionIQ

Understand Risk. Protect Capital.

# User Manual & Training Guide

Every tab, every button, step by step

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QUANTUM NEXUS LLC

Building Intelligent Solutions for a Smarter Future

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# How to use this manual

This manual is both a reference and a training course. It explains every screen, every button and every box in OptionIQ, in plain language, with a picture of each one.

- **New to OptionIQ?** Read Part 1 first. It takes you from the zip file to your first trade. Then try the practice exercises in Chapter 20.
- **Looking for one button?** Use the **Contents** on the next pages, or the **Index** at the back. The index lists words in A to Z order with the page where each one is explained.
- **Orange numbered circles** in the pictures match the numbered rows in the table under each picture.

All the pictures use **made-up practice trades** in three made-up accounts called Roth IRA, Brokerage and Spouse IRA. The tickers are real companies, but the prices, trades and amounts are not real.

| What you see in this manual | What it means |
|---|---|
| **Bold words** | A button, tab or box exactly as it appears on screen. |
| ⚙️ Settings → About | Click ⚙️ Settings, then go to the About part. |
| **Tip** boxes | A shortcut or good habit. |
| **Careful** boxes | Something that changes or replaces your information. |

OptionIQ is a record-keeping and research tool. It never places trades and it is not financial advice. Always check prices and details with your broker before you trade.

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# Part 1. Getting started

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# 1. Welcome to OptionIQ

OptionIQ keeps a log of the options you sell or buy and the stocks you own, in each of your brokerage accounts. It works out your profit and loss, warns you before options expire, and helps you find and judge new trades.

Everything stays on your own computer, in one folder. Nothing is sent anywhere except ticker symbols when the app looks up prices, and a regular check for a new version of the app.

**What OptionIQ can do for you**

| Area | What it does | Chapter |
|---|---|---|
| 📋 Options | Logs every option trade, open and closed, with live profit and loss | 6 |
| 🏦 Stocks | Tracks the shares you own, including shares you got from an assigned put | 7 |
| 📈 Analytics | Charts of your profit by ticker, month and week, and the money set aside for puts | 8 |
| 🏅 Scorecard | Honest results: return on the money at risk, rolls, strategies, sectors, and a comparison with the index | 9 |
| 🎯 Screener | Finds new put and covered-call trades and suggests rolls for trades you hold | 10 |
| 🔬 Analysis | A buy / hold / trim view of every stock you own or watch | 11 |
| 🔭 Discover | Scans the whole S&P 500 for new names worth watching | 12 |
| 👁️ Watchlist | A health card for each stock you hold or trade | 13 |
| 📅 Calendar | Each open option on the day it expires | 14 |
| 🔔 Reminders | Expiring options, options past expiry, and backups that are due | 16 |
| 📱 Phone app | See your trades on your iPhone or Android phone, log and close trades, and add to your watchlist | 19 |

**A few words you will see often** (the Glossary in Chapter 22 has more)

| Word | Meaning |
|---|---|
| Put | An option that lets the buyer sell 100 shares to you at the strike price. When you **sell** a put you are paid a premium and promise to buy the shares if the price falls below the strike. |
| Call | An option that lets the buyer buy 100 shares from you at the strike price. A **covered call** is a call you sell on shares you already own. |
| Premium | The money paid for an option, per share. One contract covers 100 shares, so a $1.20 premium is $120 per contract. |
| Strike | The price at which the shares would change hands. |
| Expiry | The last day of the option. |
| Net P&L | Profit and loss after the small fee the app subtracts for each contract. |

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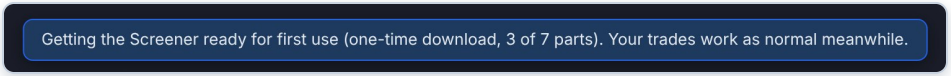
# 2. Installing OptionIQ

## On Windows

You need the file **OptionIQ.zip** and a Windows 10 or 11 computer. Nothing else has to be installed.

1. **Make a new, empty folder** for the app. For example, right-click your Desktop, choose **New → Folder**, and name it `OptionIQ`.
2. **Move the zip file into that folder.**
3. **Right-click the zip file** and choose **Extract All...**.
4. Windows suggests a new folder with the zip's name. **Delete that last part** so the box shows only your new folder, then click **Extract**. (If you leave it, everything ends up one folder deeper. That still works.)
5. Open the folder. You should see **Start OptionIQ**, **READ ME FIRST**, **README** and a folder called **app**.
6. **Double-click Start OptionIQ.** If a blue box says **"Windows protected your PC"**, click **More info**, then **Run anyway**. Windows asks this only once.
7. The app opens in its own window after a few seconds. To close it, close the window.

**The first time only**, the app downloads the parts the Screener needs (about 30 MB, usually a minute or two). A blue message at the bottom shows how far along it is. Your trades work as normal meanwhile.




*The one-time download message at the bottom of the screen on first start*

If the message turns red, the download didn't work. Check your internet and click **Try again**.

**Desktop icon.** The first time OptionIQ starts, it puts an **OptionIQ** icon on your desktop. Double-click it to start the app each day. If you delete it, ⚙️ Settings → About has a button to put it back.

## On a Mac

On a Mac you need **OptionIQ for Mac.zip** and macOS 11 (Big Sur) or newer. It works on Apple-chip and Intel Macs. Everything after this section is the same on a Mac.

1. Put the zip file where you want the app to live, for example in **Documents**.
2. **Double-click the zip file.** The Mac unzips it into a new folder called **OptionIQ**. Open it.
3. **Double-click Start OptionIQ.command.** The first time, the Mac says it can't check the file. Click **Done**, open **System Settings → Privacy & Security**, scroll down to **"Start OptionIQ.command" was blocked**, click **Open Anyway**, enter your Mac password if asked,

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and click **Open Anyway** again. On macOS 14 or earlier you can instead right-click the file, choose **Open**, then **Open**. You do this only once.

4. A **Terminal** window opens. The first time only, it downloads the app's own copy of Python (about 20 MB). When it says OptionIQ is starting, you can close the Terminal window.
5. The app opens in its own window if Chrome, Edge or Brave is installed; otherwise it opens in Safari.
6. To close it, press **⌘ Command + Q** in its window, or close its Safari tab.

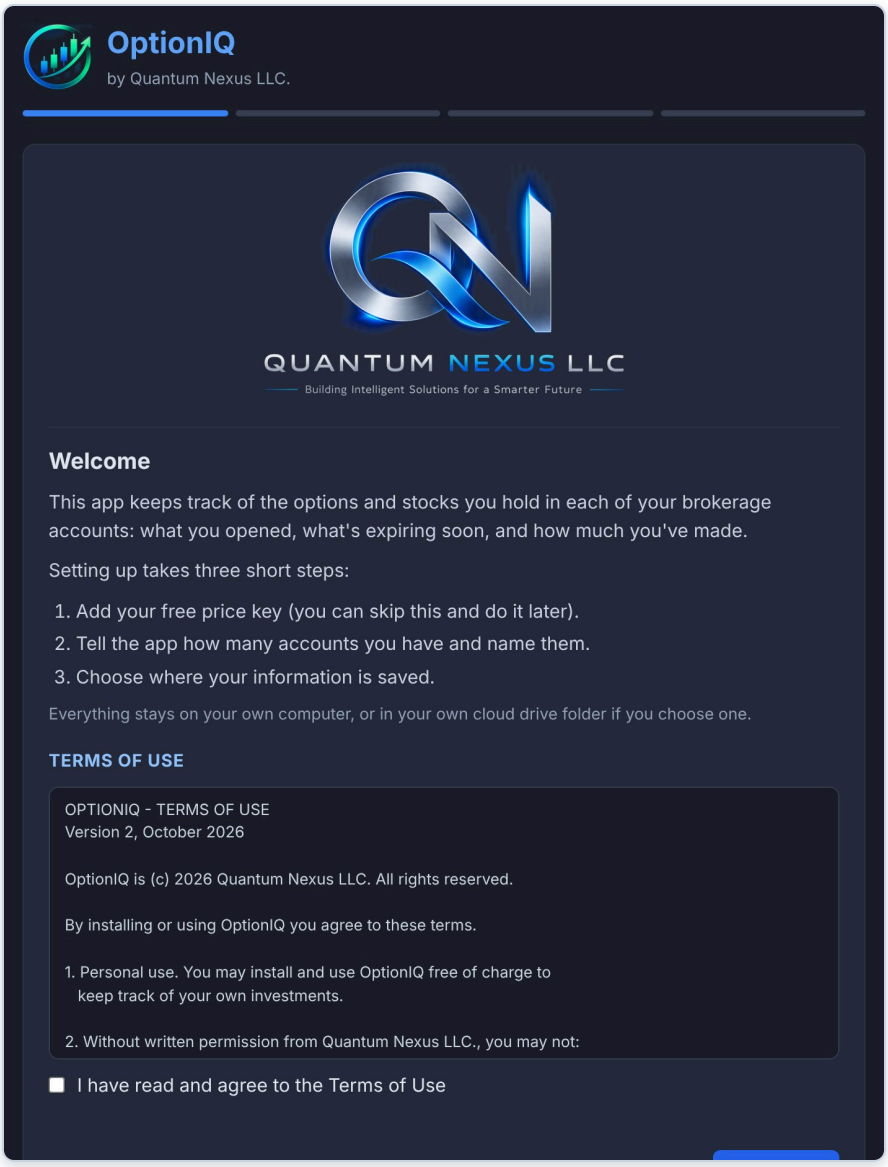
> **Tip:** OptionIQ also puts an icon on your Mac desktop. Double-click it to start the app without a Terminal window.

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# 3. First-time setup

The first time it opens, OptionIQ shows a short setup. You can change every answer later in ⚙️ Settings.

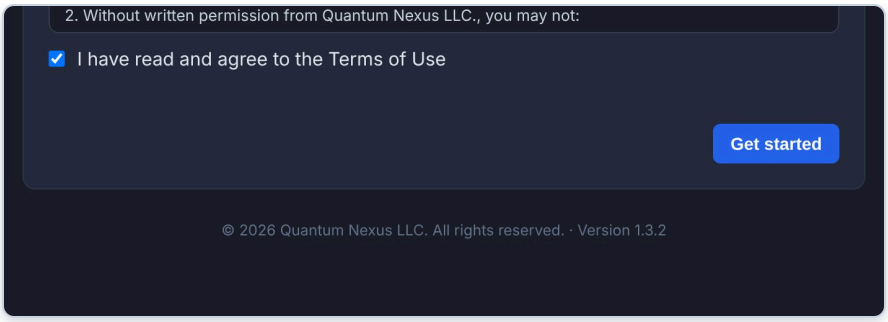
## Step 1: Welcome and Terms of Use




*The Welcome screen*

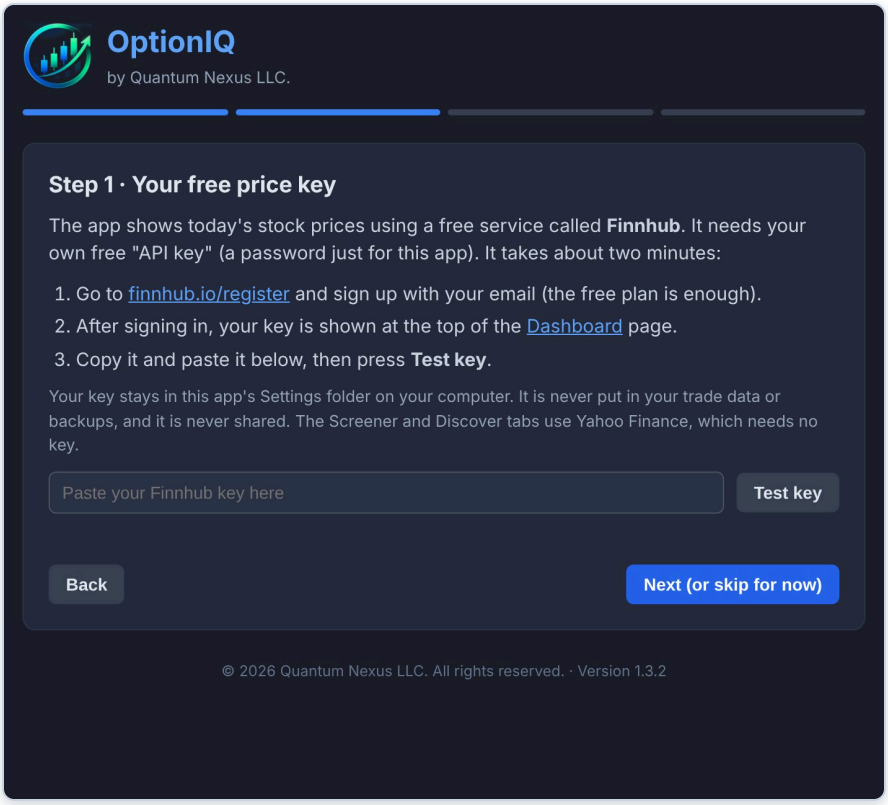
Read the Terms of Use in the box. Tick **I have read and agree to the Terms of Use**, then click **Get started**. The button stays grey until the box is ticked.

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*Tick the box, then Get started turns blue*

## Step 2: Your free price key

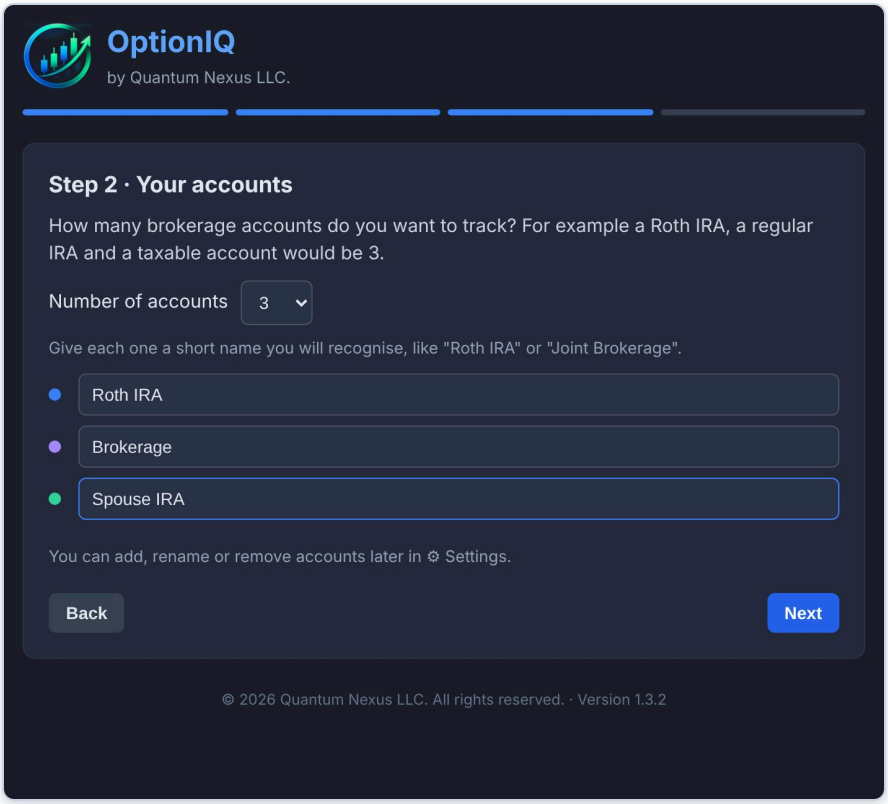



*Setup step 1 of 3: the price key*

Paste your free Finnhub key and click **Test key**, or click **Next (or skip for now)** and add it later. Chapter 4 shows how to get a key in about two minutes.

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## Step 3: Your accounts

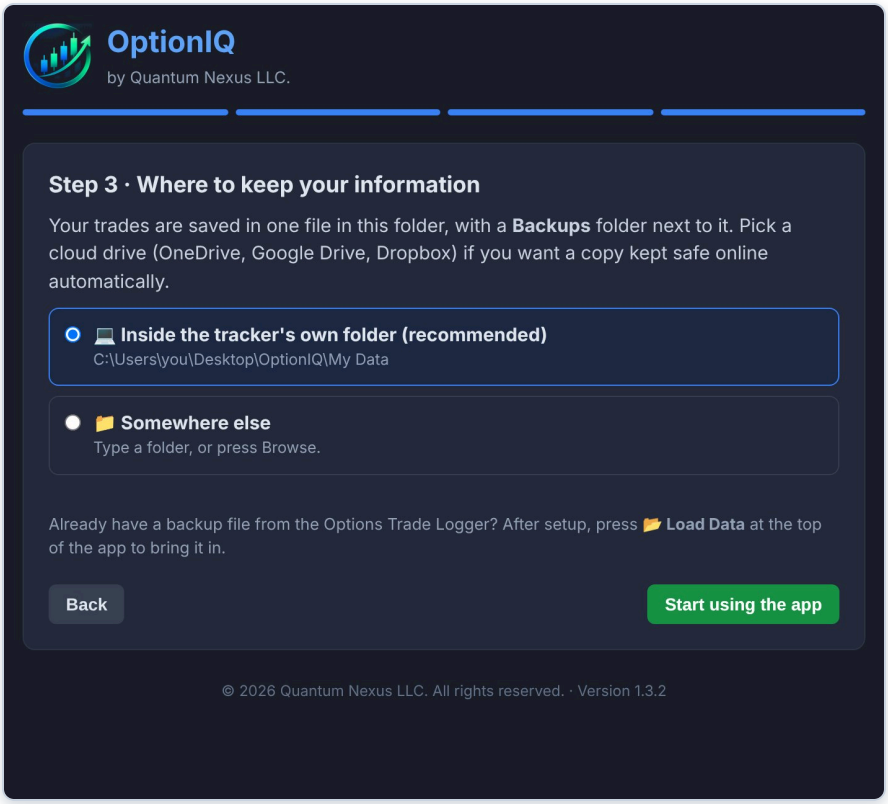



*Setup step 2 of 3: choose how many accounts and name each one*

Choose how many brokerage accounts you have (1 to 10) and type a short name for each, such as "Roth IRA" or "Joint Brokerage". Each account gets its own colour, used everywhere in the app.

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## Step 4: Where to keep your information




*Setup step 3 of 3: where your information is kept*

Choose **Inside the tracker's own folder (recommended)** so everything stays together, then click **Start using the app**.

**Already used the browser version (Options Trade Logger)?** After setup, click 📂 **Load Data** and pick your backup file. Chapter 15 explains.

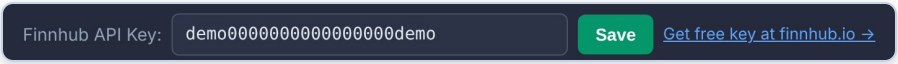
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# 4. Getting your free price key

A key (an "API key") is like a password that lets the app fetch today's stock prices from a free service called **Finnhub**. The 🔄 **Prices** and 🏔️ **Check ATH** buttons need it. The Screener, Analysis, Discover and Watchlist use Yahoo Finance, which needs no key.

Everyone gets their own key, free. Never share yours or use someone else's. The app never comes with a key in it.

1. In your web browser, go to **finnhub.io/register**.
2. Enter your email and a password, then click **Sign up**. If Finnhub emails you, click the link in that email to confirm.
3. Sign in. On your **Dashboard**, near the top, is **API Key** followed by a long line of letters and numbers.
4. Select that line, right-click and choose **Copy**.
5. In OptionIQ, paste it into the key box (in setup, in ⚙️ Settings → Price key, or with the 🔑 button) and click **Test key**.



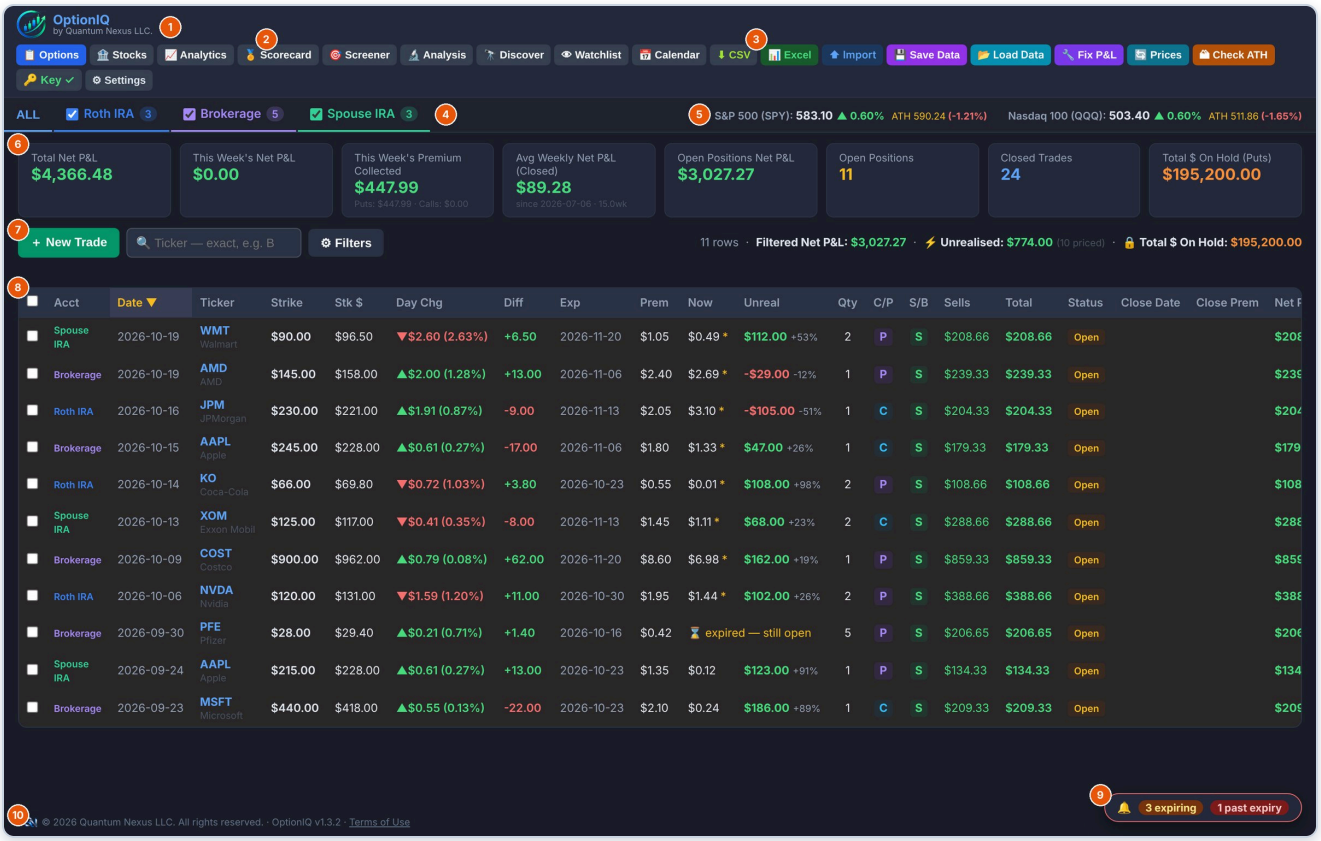

*The 🔑 Key button opens this bar. Paste the key and click Save. The link opens the Finnhub sign-up page.*

| What the app says | What to do |
|---|---|
| The key works | Nothing. It's saved. |
| Finnhub didn't accept that key | It was only partly copied. Copy and paste it again. |
| Couldn't reach Finnhub | Check your internet connection and try again. |

The free plan is enough; you never enter payment details. Your key is kept only in the app's **Settings** folder, never in your trades or backups. When a key is saved, the button reads 🔑 **Key ✔**.

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# 5. A tour of the main screen



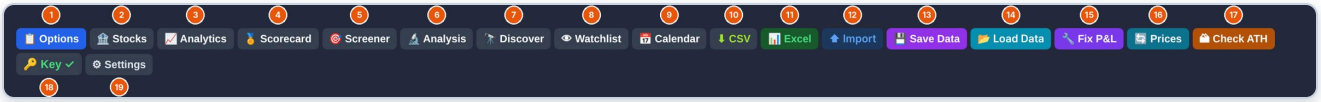

*The main screen, with the Options tab open*

| # | Part | What it is |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | OptionIQ logo | The app's name, by Quantum Nexus LLC. |
| 2 | Tab buttons | Switch between the nine screens. The one you are on is lit up. |
| 3 | Action buttons | Export, import, back up, refresh prices and open Settings. |
| 4 | Account tabs | Choose which accounts to show. |
| 5 | Market indexes | Today's S&P 500 (SPY) and Nasdaq 100 (QQQ) prices and how far each is from its all-time high. |
| 6 | Summary cards | Your totals at a glance. |
| 7 | Toolbar | Add a trade, search, filter, and see totals for what is listed. |
| 8 | Trade list | Every trade that matches your filters. |
| 9 | 🔔 Reminder button | Appears when options are expiring, past expiry, or a backup is due. |

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| # | Part | What it is |
|---|---|---|
| 10 | Footer | Copyright, the version you have, and the Terms of Use link. |

## The buttons along the top




*The 19 buttons along the top*

The first nine buttons switch screens. The rest do something right away.

| # | Button | What it does | More in |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | 📋 Options | Your option trades. | Ch. 6 |
| 2 | 🏦 Stocks | The shares you own. | Ch. 7 |
| 3 | 📈 Analytics | Charts and summaries of your trading. | Ch. 8 |
| 4 | 🏅 Scorecard | How well each strategy, stock and account really did. | Ch. 9 |
| 5 | 🎯 Screener | Finds new trades and rolls. The small number shows how many results the last run found. | Ch. 10 |
| 6 | 🔬 Analysis | Buy / hold / trim view of every stock you hold or watch. | Ch. 11 |
| 7 | 🔭 Discover | Scans the S&P 500 for new names. | Ch. 12 |
| 8 | 👁️ Watchlist | A health card for each stock you hold or trade. | Ch. 13 |
| 9 | 📅 Calendar | Your open options on the day they expire. | Ch. 14 |
| 10 | ⬇️ CSV | Saves trades as a spreadsheet file. | Ch. 15 |
| 11 | 📊 Excel | Saves a formatted Excel workbook. | Ch. 15 |
| 12 | ⬆ Import | Brings in option trades from a spreadsheet. | Ch. 15 |
| 13 | 💾 Save Data | Makes a full backup right now. | Ch. 15 |
| 14 | 📂 Load Data | Brings back a full backup. | Ch. 15 |
| 15 | 🔧 Fix P&L | Recalculates the profit on every trade. | Ch. 15 |
| 16 | 🔄 Prices | Fetches the latest stock and option prices. | Ch. 15 |
| 17 | 🏔️ Check ATH | Looks up the all-time highs of SPY and QQQ. | Ch. 15 |

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| # | Button | What it does | More in |
|---|---|---|---|
| 18 | 🔑 Key | Enter or change your Finnhub price key. Shows ✓ when a key is saved. | Ch. 4 |
| 19 | ⚙️ Settings | Accounts, backups, reminders, key, data folder and About. | Ch. 17 |

## Account tabs and market indexes




*Account tabs on the left, market indexes on the right*

Each account has a coloured tab with a tick box and a small number: how many open positions it has.

- **Untick** an account to hide its trades and leave them out of the totals. Tick it again to bring it back.
- Click **ALL** to show every account together.
- The choice applies to every tab: Options, Stocks, Analytics, Scorecard and the Calendar.

On the right, **S&P 500 (SPY)** and **Nasdaq 100 (QQQ)** show today's price and change, and **ATH**: the all-time high, with how far below it the index is now. Click 🏔️ **Check ATH** to refresh the all-time highs.

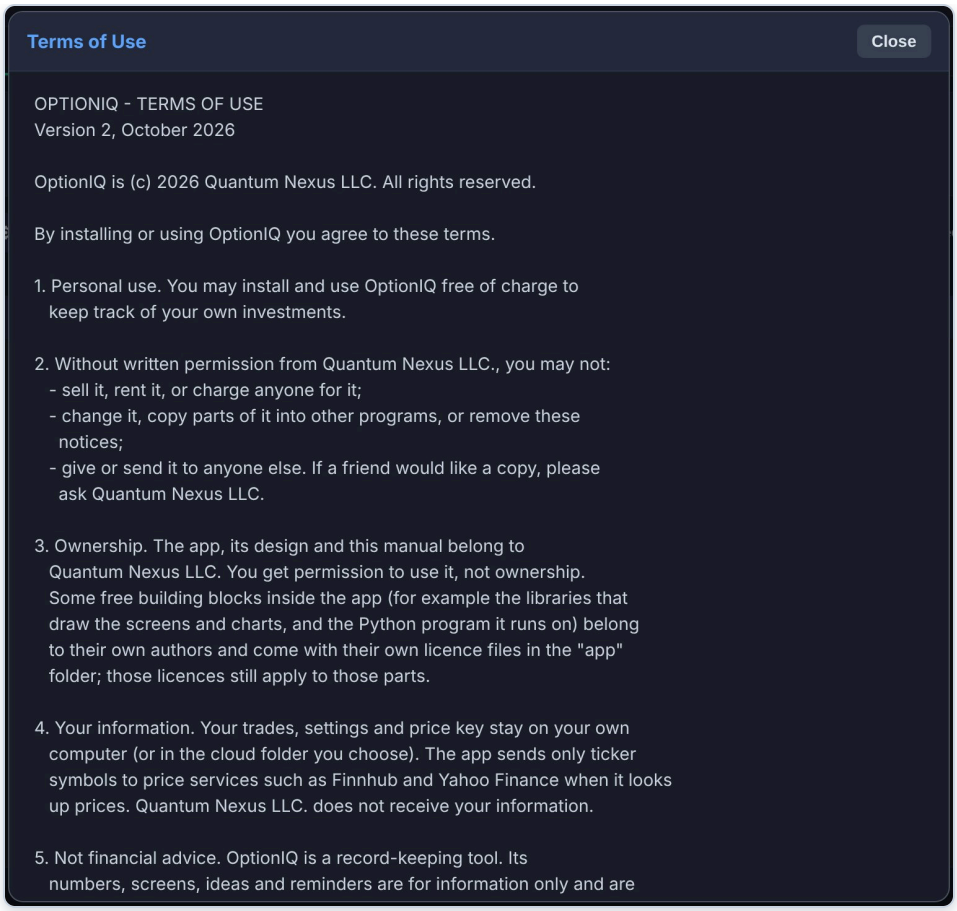
## The footer




*The line at the bottom of every screen*

The bottom line shows the copyright, the version number you have (for example **OptionIQ v1.7**) and a **Terms of Use** link that opens the full terms.

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*The Terms of Use window*

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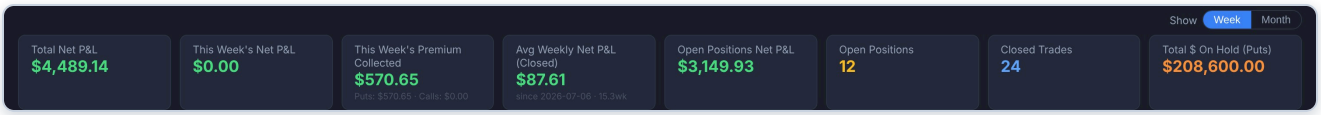

# Part 2. The tabs, one by one

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# 6. The Options tab

This is the screen you will use most. It lists your option trades and works out your profit.

## Summary cards




*The eight summary cards, with the Week | Month switch above them*

The small **Show Week | Month** switch above the cards changes three of them between this week (Monday to Friday) and this calendar month. OptionIQ remembers your choice.

| Card | What it shows |
|---|---|
| Total Net P&L | All profit and loss, open and closed trades, after fees. |
| This Week's (or Month's) Net P&L | Profit from trades that closed this week, or this month. |
| This Week's (or Month's) Premium Collected | Premium from options you sold this week, or this month, split into Puts and Calls underneath. |
| Avg Weekly (or Monthly) Net P&L (Closed) | Average profit per week, or per month, from closed trades, since your first trade. |
| Open Positions Net P&L | The premium you hold in trades that are still open. |
| Open Positions | How many trades are open. |
| Closed Trades | How many trades are closed. |
| Total $ On Hold (Puts) | Cash your broker sets aside for the puts you sold: strike × 100 × contracts. |

The cards follow your account tabs: untick an account and its numbers leave the cards.

## The toolbar




*The Options toolbar*

| Part | What it does |
|---|---|
| **+ New Trade** | Opens a pop-up window to log a new trade (see below). |
| Search box | Type a ticker, for example `AAPL`, to show only that stock. |
| ⚙️ **Filters** | Opens more ways to narrow the list. A small number shows how many filters are on, and **✕ Clear** turns them all off. |
| rows | How many trades are listed now. |

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| Part | What it does |
|---|---|
| Filtered Net P&L | Total profit of just the trades listed. |
| ⚡ Unrealised | If you closed all listed open trades now, the profit you would keep. "(10 priced)" means 10 trades had a live option price. |
| 💰 Money Required (Puts ITM) | Shows only when a sold put is in the money: the cash you would need if it were assigned. |
| 🔒 Total $ On Hold | Cash set aside for the listed puts. |

## Filters




*The Filters panel*

| Filter | What it does |
|---|---|
| Status | All, **Open only** (the normal choice) or Closed only. |
| Call/Put, Sell/Buy | Show only calls or puts, only options you sold or bought. |
| Ticker | Pick one stock. |
| Open Date From / To, Close Date From / To | Show trades opened or closed between two dates. |
| Min / Max Net P&L | Show only trades above or below an amount. |
| Max DTE, with **7d**, **14d**, **30d** | Show only options expiring within that many days. DTE means days to expiry. |
| Has $ On Hold | Only puts that tie up cash. |
| ITM Only | Only options that are in the money now. |

> **Tip:** the filters stay as you left them until you click **✕ Clear**. If trades seem to be missing, check the filter count first.

## The trade list

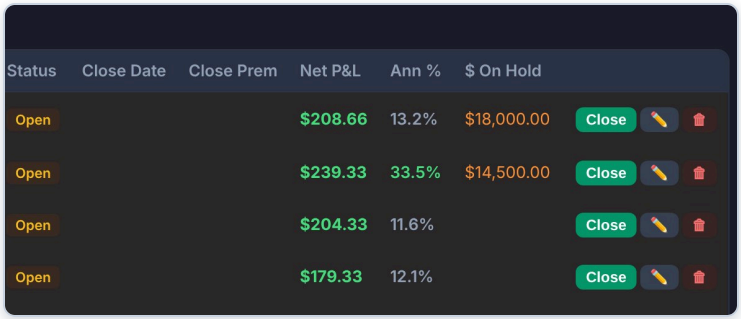
Each row is one trade. Click a column heading to sort by it; click again to reverse the order.

| Column | Meaning |
|---|---|
| ☐ | Tick to select a row (see "Deleting several trades" below). |
| Acct | The account, in its colour. |
| Date | The day you opened the trade. |

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| Column | Meaning |
|---|---|
| Ticker | The stock. Click it to open a price chart, with a link to **Open in Yahoo Finance ↗**. |
| Strike | The strike price. |
| Stk $ | The latest stock price (after 🔄 Prices). |
| Day Chg | Today's change in the stock price, in dollars and percent. |
| Diff | Stock price minus strike. For a sold put, a positive number is good (the stock is above the strike). |
| Exp | The expiry date. |
| Prem | The premium per share when you opened it. |
| Now | Today's option price per share. `*` means the middle of bid and ask; ⌛ means the price is old. "⌛ expired — still open" means the expiry date has passed but you haven't closed the trade yet. |
| Unreal | Profit you would keep if you closed now, with the percent of the premium already earned. |
| Qty | Number of contracts. |
| C/P, S/B | Call or Put; Sold or Bought. |
| Sells, Total | The premium in dollars after the fee. |
| Status | Open or Closed. |
| Close Date, Close Prem | When and for how much it was closed. |
| Net P&L | The profit or loss of the trade. |
| Ann % | Yearly rate of return for the trade. Hover for how it was worked out. |
| $ On Hold | Cash set aside for this put. |

## Row buttons



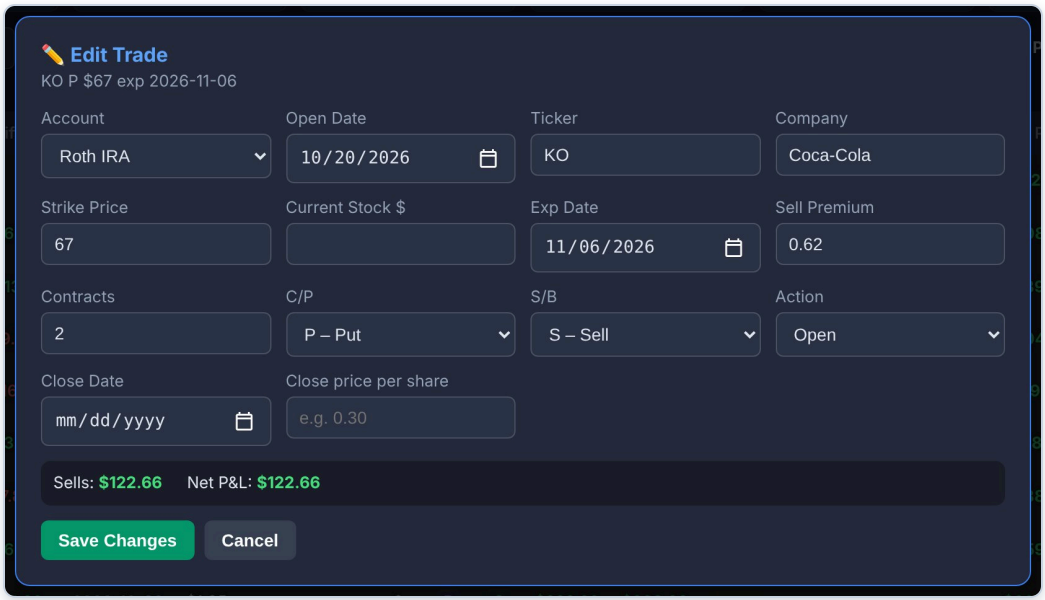

*At the right end of each row: Close, edit and delete*

| Button | What it does |
|---|---|
| **Close** | Opens the Close / Roll window for an open trade (see below). Closed trades don't have it. |
| ✏️ | Opens the Edit Trade pop-up for this trade. |

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| Button | What it does |
|---|---|
| 🗑️ | Delete this trade. The app asks first. |

When you click ✏️, the **Edit Trade** window opens in the middle of the screen. It has the same large boxes as New Trade, filled in with the trade's current values, plus **Close Date** and **Close price per share**. For a closed trade, the close price box shows the price per share worked out from the saved total; type a new price to change it, and the small line under the box shows the dollar total that will be saved. The line under the boxes shows the **Sells** and **Net P&L** as you type. Change what you need, then click **Save Changes**, or **Cancel** to close without changing anything.



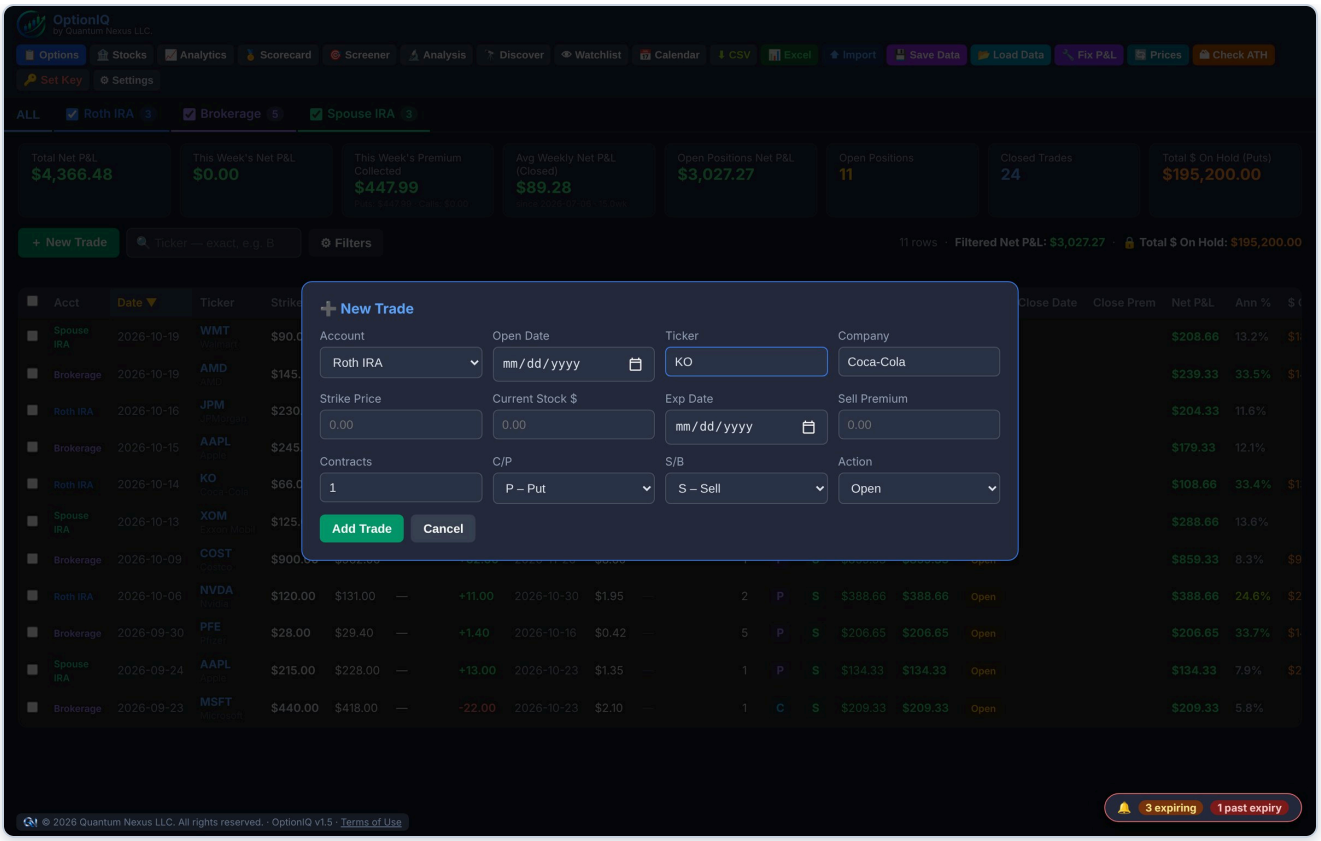

*The Edit Trade window*

> **Tip:** to close or roll a trade, use the **Close** button instead. It works out the numbers and moves shares for you. If you do change **Action** to Assigned or Called Away here, the shares are moved the same way.

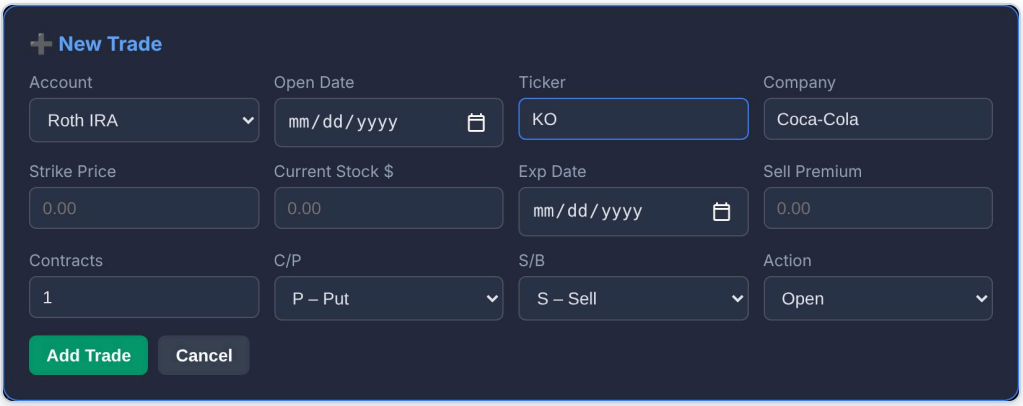
## Logging a new trade

Click **+ New Trade**. The New Trade window opens in the middle of the screen, over the list, so you can see it however far down you have scrolled. Fill in the boxes and click **Add Trade**, or **Cancel** to close it.

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*The New Trade window opens over the list*




*The New Trade form*

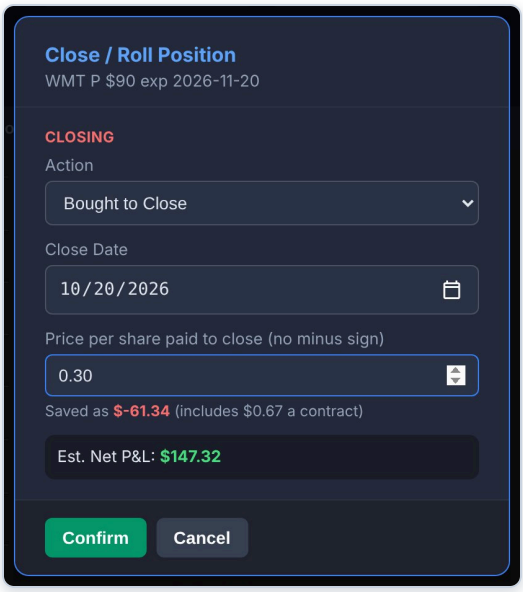
| Box | What to enter |
|---|---|
| Account | Which account the trade is in. |
| Open Date | The day you opened it. It starts on today's date; change it if you traded on another day. |
| Ticker | The stock symbol, for example KO. |
| Company | Filled in for you from the ticker. |
| Strike Price | The strike. |
| Current Stock $ | The stock price when you traded (optional). |

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| Box | What to enter |
|---|---|
| Exp Date | The expiry date. |
| Sell Premium | The premium per share. |
| Contracts | How many contracts. |
| C/P | Call or Put. |
| S/B | Sell (you received the premium) or Buy (you paid it). |
| Action | Leave as **Open** for a new trade. |

The line under the form shows what the trade collects (**Sells**) and, for a put, the cash it puts **On Hold**. Click **Add Trade** to save it, or **Cancel**.

## Closing or rolling a trade




*The Close / Roll window*

Click **Close** on an open trade. Choose what happened in **Action**:

| Action | When to use it |
|---|---|
| Expired | The option ran out worthless. You keep the whole premium. |
| Assigned | Your sold put was exercised and you bought the shares. The app adds the shares to 🏦 Stocks for you (100 × contracts, at the strike price). |
| Called Away | Your covered call was exercised and your shares were sold. The app asks, then sells the shares from your oldest lot. |
| Bought to Close | You bought the option back before expiry. |
| Sold to Close | You sold an option you had bought. |

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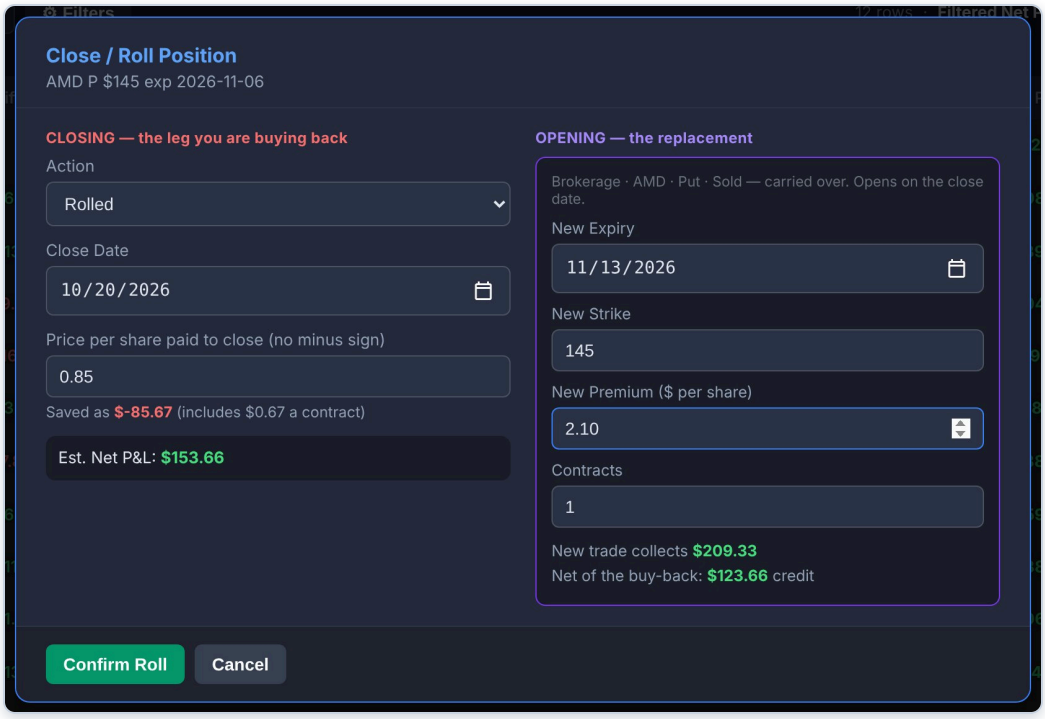
| Action | When to use it |
|---|---|
| Rolled | You bought it back and sold a new one on the same stock. |

Fill in **Close Date** (it starts on today's date) and the **price per share**, the same way you type the premium for a new trade. Type it as a plain number, for example `0.30`, with **no minus sign**; the minus key does nothing in this box.

- For an option you **sold** (most trades), the box says **Price per share paid to close**. Buying it back costs money, so the app saves the total as a negative amount: price × contracts × 100, plus $0.67 a contract. For example, 0.30 on 2 contracts is saved as **-$61.34**.
- For an option you **bought**, the box says **Price per share received**. The app saves price × contracts × 100, less $0.67 a contract, as a positive amount.

The line under the box shows exactly what will be saved (**Saved as ...**). Leave the box empty for Expired, Assigned and Called Away. **Est. Net P&L** shows the result. Click **Confirm** to save, or **Cancel**. The Options list, reports and exports still show the dollar totals, and trades closed before version 1.6 are not changed.

When you choose **Rolled**, a second part opens on the right: **OPENING — the replacement**. Fill in the **New Expiry**, **New Strike**, **New Premium** and **Contracts**. The window shows what the new trade collects and the **Net of the buy-back** (a credit is good). Click **Confirm Roll**. The old trade is closed, the new one is logged, and the two are linked so the 🏅 Scorecard can show the whole roll as one chain.

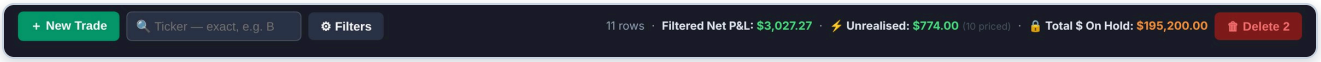



*Rolling: the replacement trade on the right*

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> **Careful:** for a **call** that was assigned, choose **Called Away**, not Assigned. If a call is marked Assigned, the app reminds you to sell the shares yourself on 🏦 Stocks → Sell.

## Deleting several trades

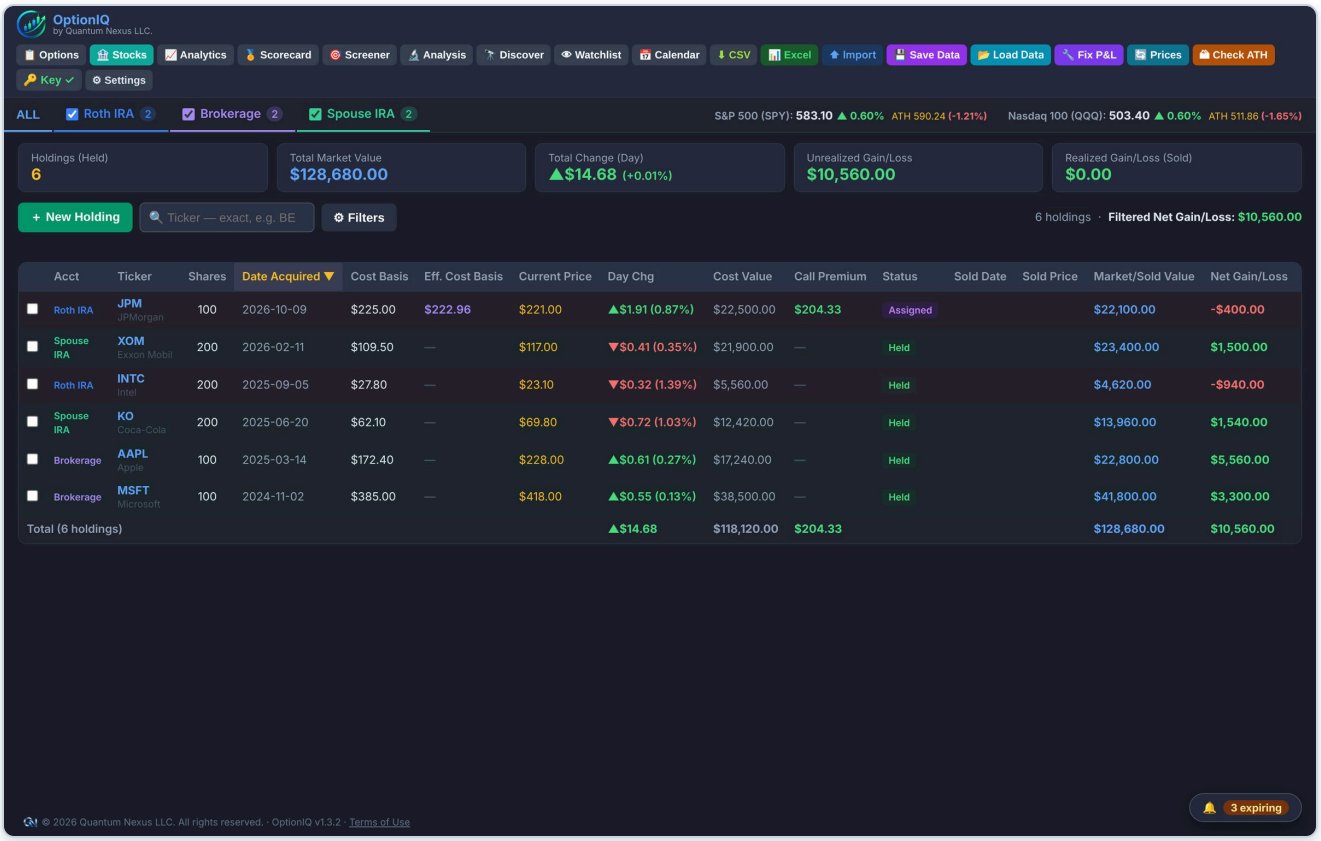



*Tick rows and a red Delete button appears*

Tick the box at the start of several rows. A red 🗑️ **Delete N** button appears in the toolbar. Click it to delete them all (the app asks first). **Careful:** deleting can't be undone, so press 💾 Save Data first.

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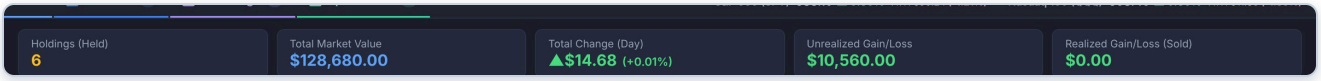
# 7. The Stocks tab




*The Stocks tab*

This tab lists the shares you own in each account, and shares you have sold.

## Summary cards



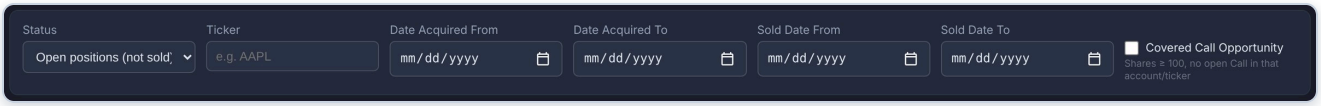

*The Stocks summary cards*

| Card | What it shows |
|---|---|
| Holdings (Held) | How many holdings you still own. |
| Total Market Value | What they are worth at today's prices. |
| Total Change (Day) | How much their value moved today. |
| Unrealized Gain/Loss | Gain or loss on shares you still own. |
| Realized Gain/Loss (Sold) | Gain or loss on shares you have sold. |

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## Toolbar and filters

The toolbar has **+ New Holding**, a search box, ⚙️ **Filters**, the number of holdings listed, and **Filtered Net Gain/Loss**. When you tick rows, a red 🗑️ **Delete N** button appears, just as on the Options tab.




*The Stocks filters*

| Filter | What it does |
|---|---|
| Status | All, Open positions (not sold), Held only, Assigned only, or Sold only. |
| Ticker | Pick one stock. |
| Date Acquired From / To, Sold Date From / To | Narrow by date. |
| Covered Call Opportunity | Shows only holdings with at least 100 shares and no open call on them: shares you could sell a covered call on. |

## The holdings list

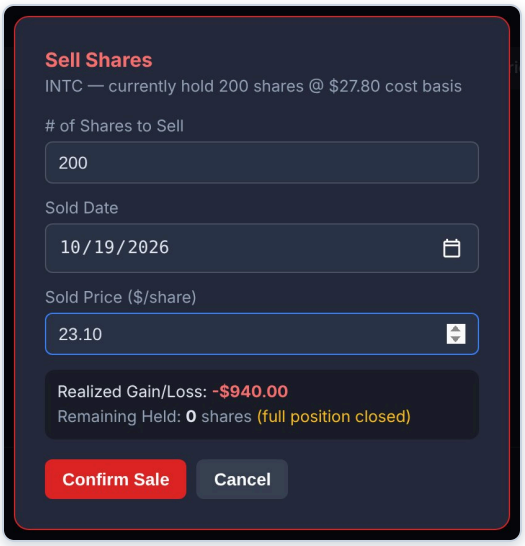
| Column | Meaning |
|---|---|
| Shares, Date Acquired | How many shares and when you got them. |
| Cost Basis | What you paid per share. |
| Eff. Cost Basis | Your cost after subtracting the call premium you collected on these shares. |
| Current Price, Day Chg | Today's price and change. |
| Cost Value | Shares × cost basis. |
| Call Premium | For assigned shares: premium earned from calls sold on them. |
| Status | Held, Assigned (from a put) or Sold. |
| Sold Date, Sold Price | For sold shares. |
| Market/Sold Value | Value now, or what you sold for. |
| Net Gain/Loss, % | Your gain or loss in dollars and percent. |



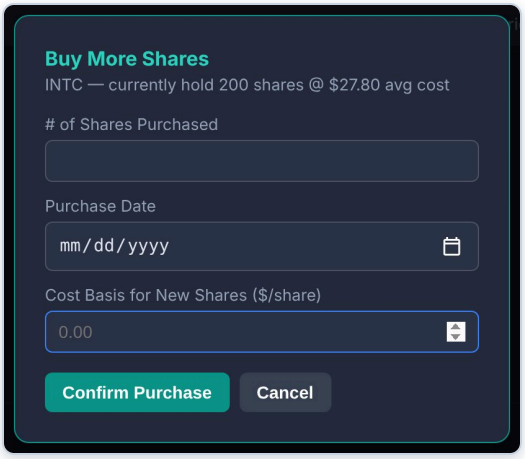

*Row buttons: Buy More, Sell, edit and delete*

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| Button | What it does |
|---|---|
| **Buy More** | Add shares to a holding. The window shows the **New Total Shares** and **New Average Cost Basis**. |
| **Sell** | Sell some or all shares. The window shows the **Realized Gain/Loss** and how many remain held. |
| ✏️ / 🗑️ | ✏️ opens the Edit Holding pop-up; 🗑️ deletes the holding. |




*Sell Shares window*




*Buy More Shares window*

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## Adding a holding




*The New Stock Holding form*

Click **+ New Holding**. A pop-up window opens in the middle of the screen. Fill in the **Account**, **Ticker** (the company name fills in), **# of Shares**, **Date Acquired**, **Cost Basis** per share, **Current Price** (optional; 🔄 Prices fills it in) and **Status** (Held, Assigned (from Put) or Sold). Click **Add Holding** to save, or **Cancel** to close it.

> **Tip:** shares you get from an assigned put are added for you when you close the put as **Assigned**. You don't need to add them by hand.

## Editing a holding

Click ✏️ at the end of a holding's row. The **Edit Holding** window opens with the holding's current values in large boxes, and shows the cost value, market value and gain or loss as you type. Change what you need and click **Save Changes**, or **Cancel**.



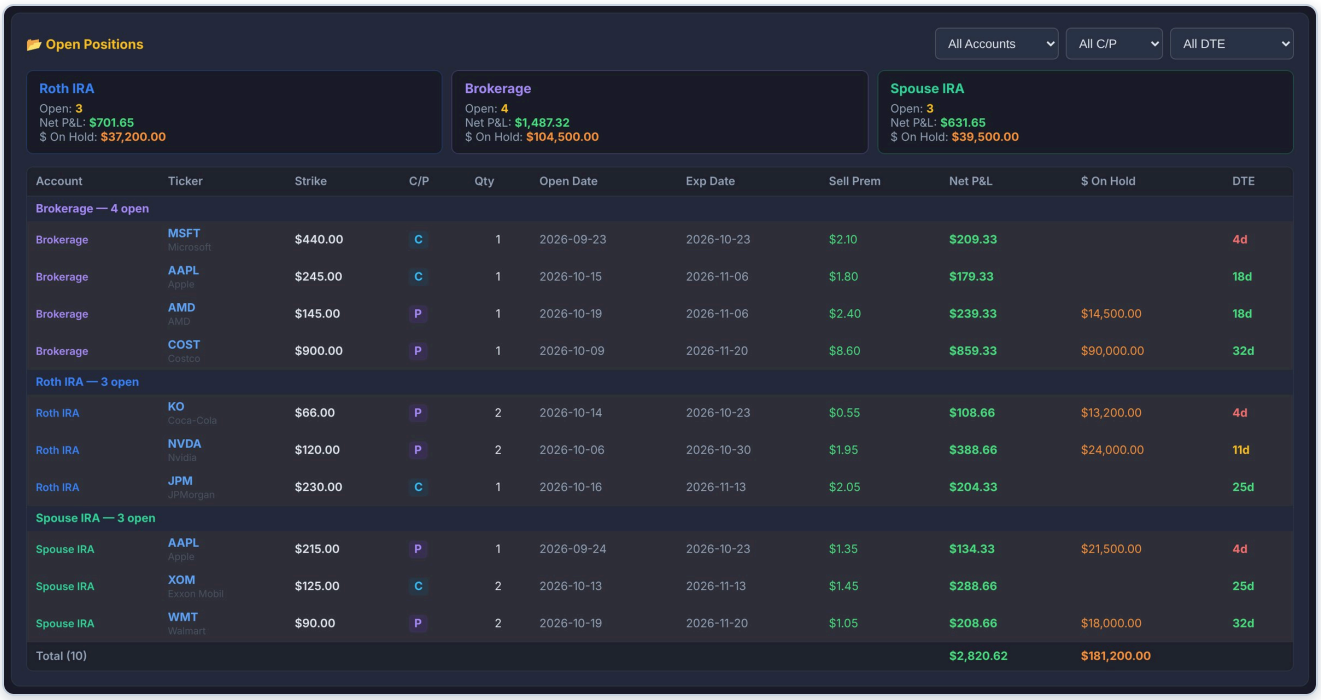

*The Edit Holding window*

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# 8. The Analytics tab

Analytics shows your trading in tables and charts. Every part follows the account tabs at the top.

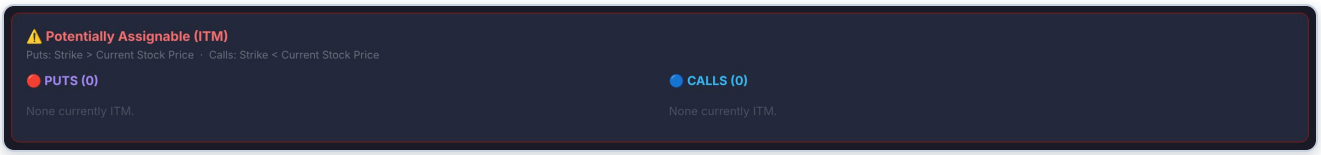
## Open positions




*Open Positions, grouped by account*

Use the drop-downs at the top right to show **All Accounts** or one, **All C/P** or only calls or puts, and **All DTE** or only options expiring within 7, 14 or 30 days. Each account card shows how many trades are open, their Net P&L and the cash on hold. The table groups open trades by account, with **DTE** (days to expiry) in the last column: red when it is very close.

## Potentially assignable (in the money)

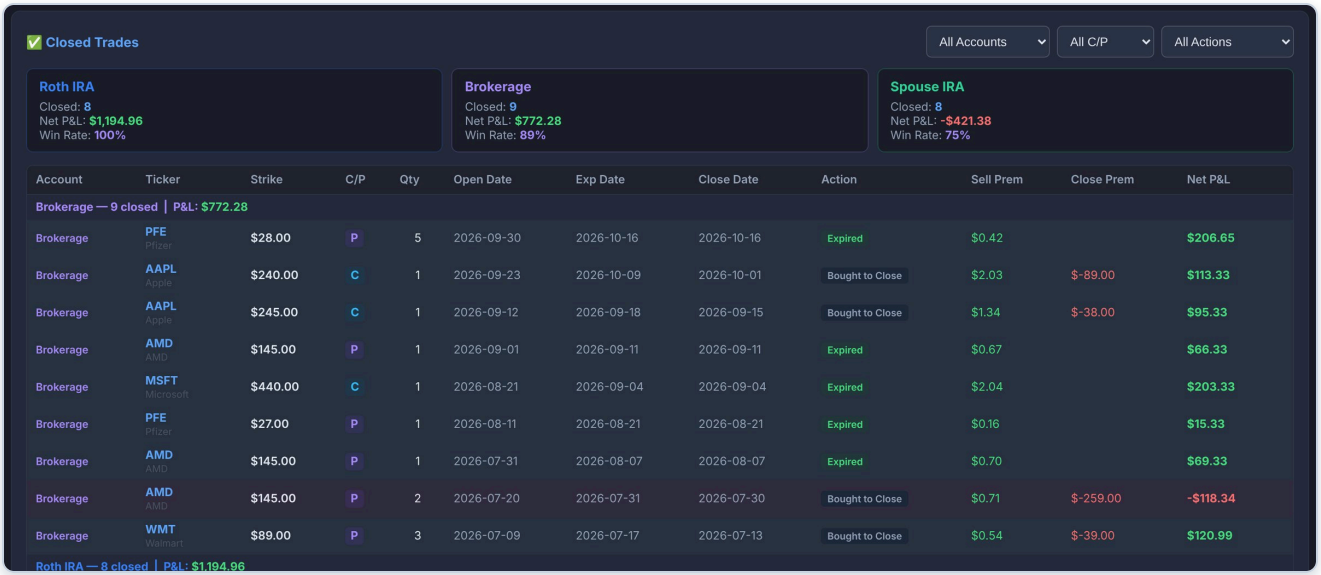



*Puts and calls that are in the money*

This box lists sold **puts** whose stock is now below the strike, and sold **calls** whose stock is above the strike. These could be assigned. "None currently ITM" means nothing is at risk right now.

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## Closed trades




*Closed trades, with a win rate per account*

Filter by account, call/put and **Action** (Expired, Bought to Close, and so on). Each account card shows the number of closed trades, Net P&L and **Win Rate**: the percent of closed trades that made money. Losing trades are tinted red.

## Charts




*P&L by Ticker*

**P&L by Ticker** shows total profit for each stock, best first. Red bars are losses.




*P&L by Month*

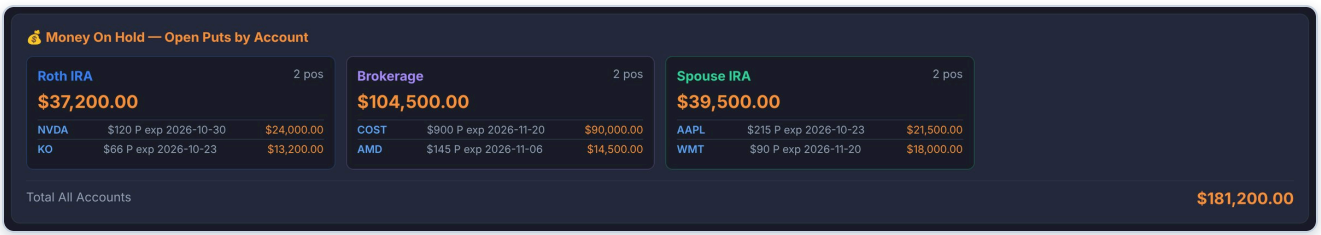
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**P&L by Month** shows profit for each calendar month.




*P&L by Week, with a running total line*

**P&L by Week** shows a green or red bar for each week (closed trades, by the Friday of that week) and an orange line for the running total.




*Money On Hold, open puts by account*

**Money On Hold** shows the cash set aside for open puts in each account, the puts that make it up, and the total.




*Weekly Premium Collected, Puts vs Calls, and Premium by Account*

**Weekly Premium Collected** shows the premium you received each week from puts (purple) and calls (blue). **Premium Collected by Account** totals it for each account since you started.

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# 9. The Scorecard tab

The Scorecard answers "how well is this really working?" It looks at the money you put at risk and how long it was at risk, not just the dollars you kept.

## Headline cards




*The four headline numbers*

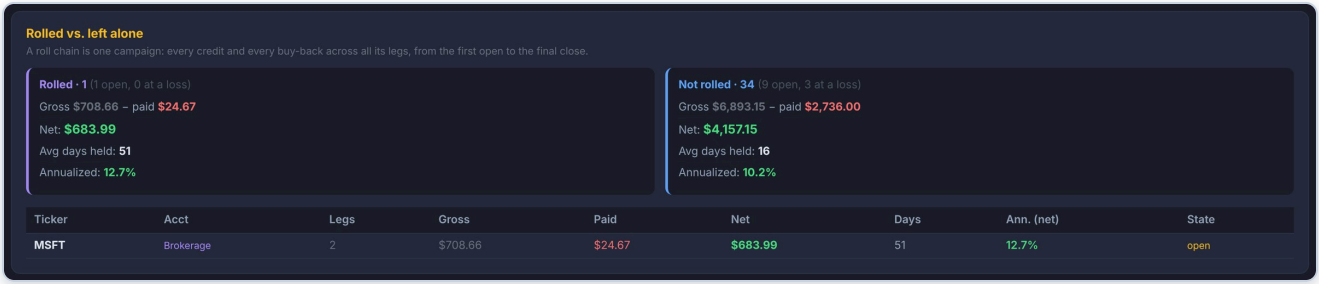
| Card | Meaning |
|---|---|
| Annualized on capital at risk | Your net premium as a yearly rate on the money at risk, weighted by how long it was at risk. |
| Net premium kept | Premium received minus what you paid to close. |
| Gross premium | All premium received. |
| Period | From your first trade to today. |




*How the Scorecard ties back to the Options tab*

**How this reconciles with the Options tab** shows the sum: gross premium minus what you paid to close equals net, which matches the Options tab's Total Net P&L.

## Rolled vs. left alone

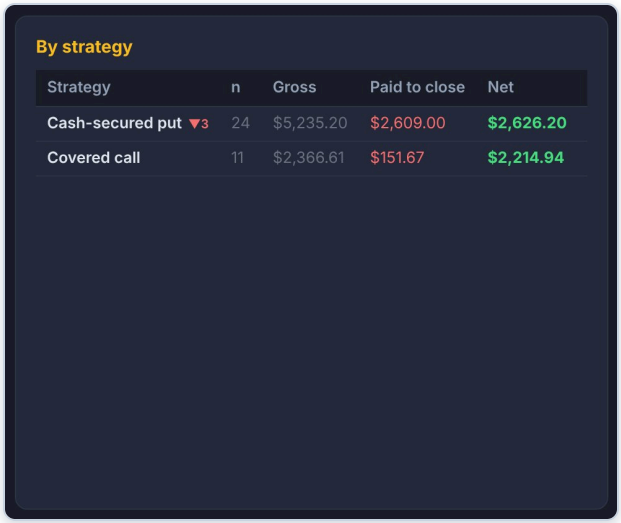



*Rolls are counted as one chain from first open to final close*

A roll chain is treated as one campaign: every credit and every buy-back across all its legs, from the first open to the final close. The two boxes compare trades you **rolled** with trades you **left alone**, and the table lists each chain. Chains are linked only when you roll with the **Rolled** action in the Close window.

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## By strategy, underlying and account

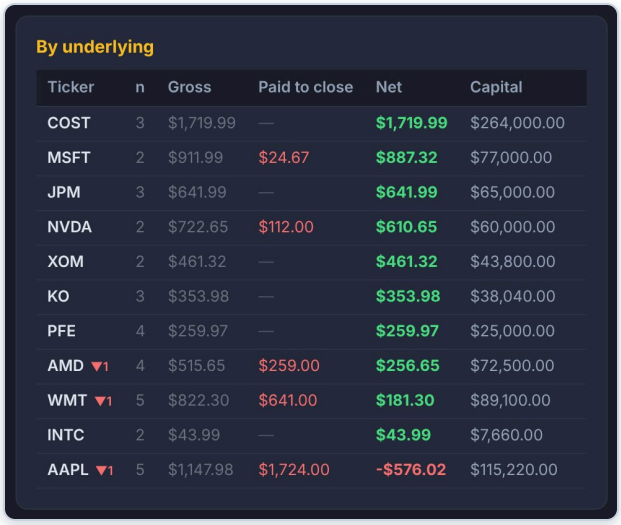


By strategy

| Strategy | n | Gross | Paid to close | Net |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Cash-secured put ▼3 | 24 | $5,235.20 | $2,609.00 | $2,626.20 |
| Covered call | 11 | $2,366.61 | $151.67 | $2,214.94 |

*Results by strategy, by stock, and by account*

Three tables split results by **strategy** (cash-secured put, covered call), by **underlying** stock and by **account**. A small red ▼ with a number shows how many losing trades are in that row. **Capital** is the money that was at risk.

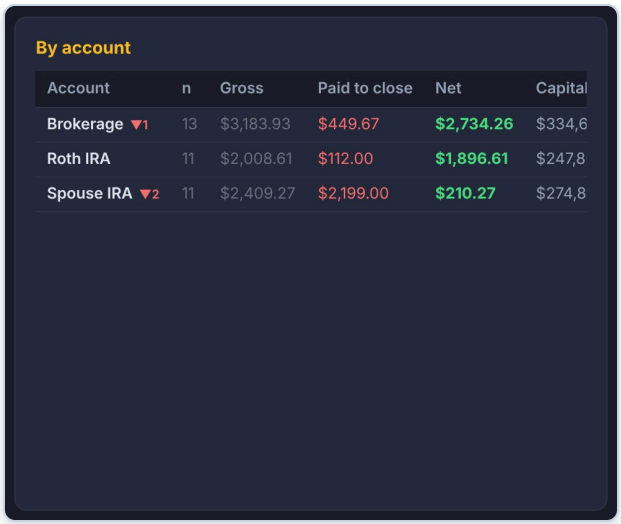


By underlying

| Ticker | n | Gross | Paid to close | Net | Capital |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| COST | 3 | $1,719.99 | — | $1,719.99 | $264,000.00 |
| MSFT | 2 | $911.99 | $24.67 | $887.32 | $77,000.00 |
| JPM | 3 | $641.99 | — | $641.99 | $65,000.00 |
| NVDA | 2 | $722.65 | $112.00 | $610.65 | $60,000.00 |
| XOM | 2 | $461.32 | — | $461.32 | $43,800.00 |
| KO | 3 | $353.98 | — | $353.98 | $38,040.00 |
| PFE | 4 | $259.97 | — | $259.97 | $25,000.00 |
| AMD ▼1 | 4 | $515.65 | $259.00 | $256.65 | $72,500.00 |
| WMT ▼1 | 5 | $822.30 | $641.00 | $181.30 | $89,100.00 |
| INTC | 2 | $43.99 | — | $43.99 | $7,660.00 |
| AAPL ▼1 | 5 | $1,147.98 | $1,724.00 | -$576.02 | $115,220.00 |

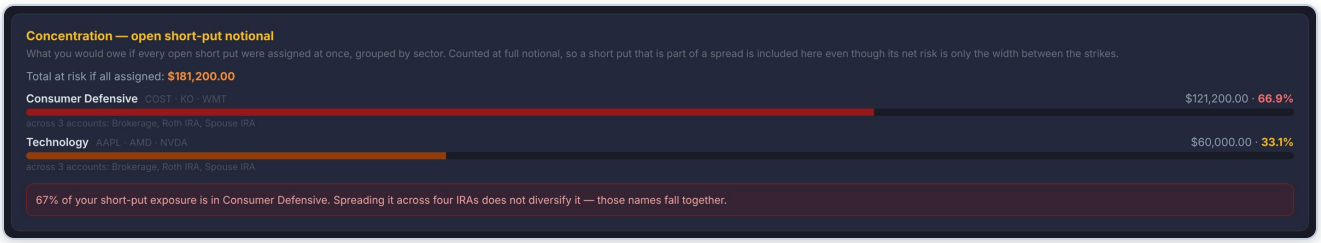
*By underlying*

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*By account*

## Concentration




*How much of your put risk sits in each sector*

If every open put were assigned at once, how much stock would you have to buy, and in which sectors? A red warning appears when too much sits in one sector. Sectors come from the 🔬 Analysis tab, so run it once first; until then everything shows as Unclassified.

## Against simply holding the index




*Your return compared with SPY and QQQ*

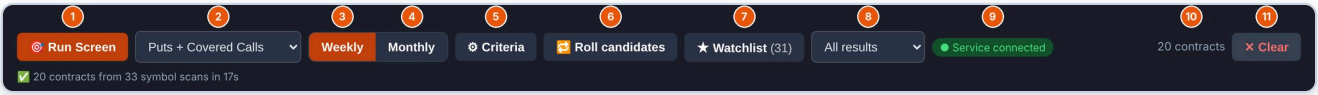
Click 📊 **Fetch SPY / QQQ** (later 🔄 **Refresh**) to compare your yearly return with simply owning the S&P 500 (SPY) or Nasdaq 100 (QQQ) over the same dates. It needs the Screener service.

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# 10. The Screener tab

The Screener looks for new trades to place: **cash-secured puts** on the stocks in your watchlist, and **covered calls** on shares you hold. It also suggests **rolls** for options you already have. It uses free Yahoo Finance data, so it needs no key, but it needs the internet and the one-time download from Chapter 2.

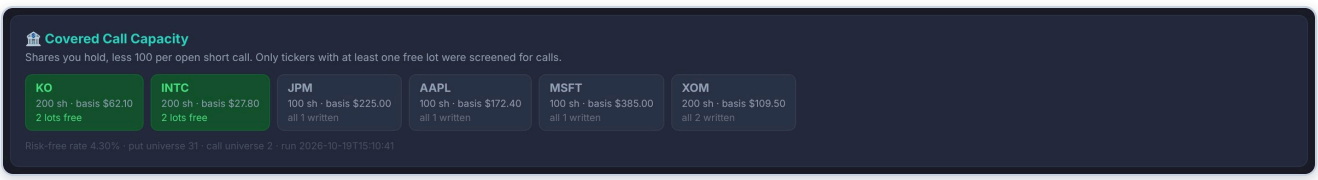
## The Screener bar




*The Screener bar*

| # | Button | What it does |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | 🎯 Run Screen | Checks every ticker on your watchlist and lists the contracts that pass your rules. Takes from a few seconds to a minute. |
| 2 | Side | **Puts + Covered Calls**, **Cash-Secured Puts only** or **Covered Calls only**. |
| 3 | Weekly | Fills in rules for short trades: 4 to 14 days, delta 0.10 to 0.25, at least $40 per contract. |
| 4 | Monthly | Fills in rules for longer trades: 21 to 45 days, delta 0.15 to 0.30, at least $75 per contract. If you change any rule, neither button is lit ("Custom"). |
| 5 | ⚙️ Criteria | Opens all the rules (below). |
| 6 | 🔁 Roll candidates | Suggests rolls for options you hold (below). |
| 7 | ★ Watchlist (31) | Opens the list of tickers the Screener checks. |
| 8 | Results filter | Show **All results**, **Puts only** or **Calls only**. |
| 9 | Service connected | Green means the Screener's helper is running. If it is red, click ↻ **Retry**, or close and reopen the app. |
| 10 | contracts | How many contracts are listed. |
| 11 | ✕ Clear | Clears the results. |

## Covered Call Capacity




*Covered Call Capacity: which holdings have shares free for a call*

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Each card is a stock you hold. Green cards have at least one free lot of 100 shares that is not already covered by a call, so the Screener looks for calls on them. Grey cards say why not: "all 1 written" (every lot already has a call) or "under 100 sh".

## The results



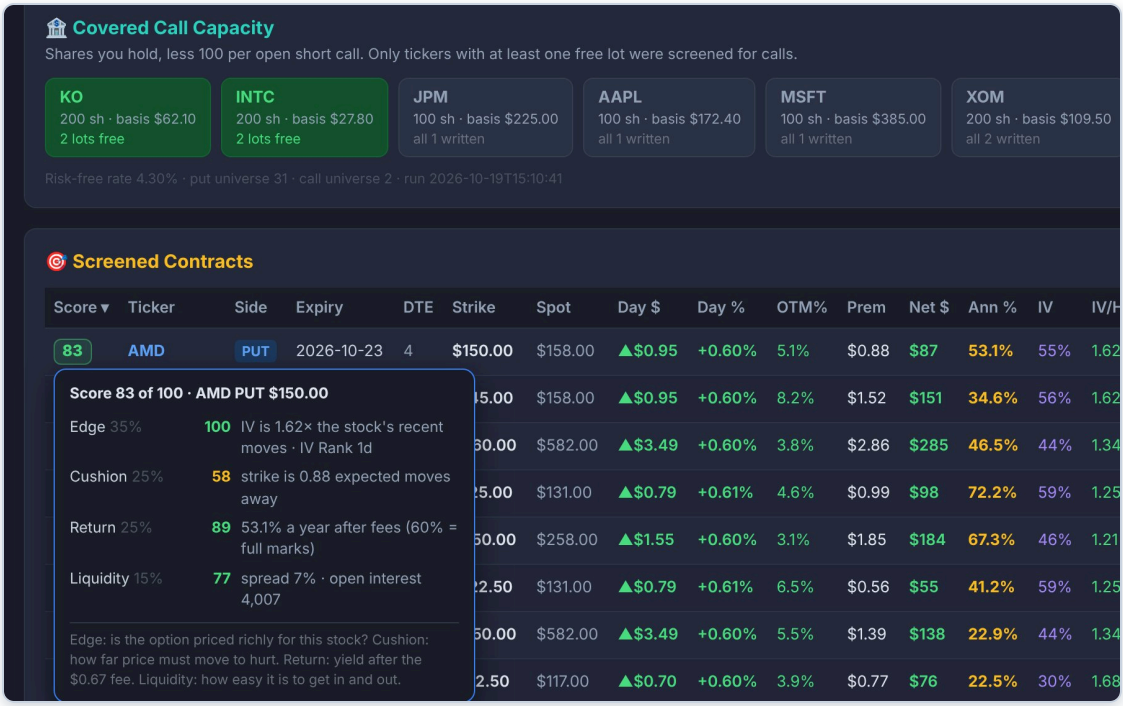

*Screened contracts, best score first*

Each row is one option contract you could sell. The list is sorted by **Score**, best first.

| Column | Meaning |
|---|---|
| Score | 0 to 100. Hover over it to see why (below). |
| Ticker and flags | ⚠ earnings before expiry; 💲 a dividend before expiry; ⚖️ you already have a lot in this sector; ⛰️ the strike sits near a price level the stock has bounced off before. |
| Side | PUT or CALL. |
| Expiry, DTE | Expiry date and days to expiry. |
| Strike, Spot | Strike price and today's stock price. |
| Day $, Day % | Today's stock move. |
| OTM% | How far the strike is from today's price. Bigger means safer, but less premium. |
| Prem, Net $ | Premium per share, and dollars per contract after the $0.67 fee. |
| Ann % | Yearly rate of return if it expires worthless. |
| IV, IV/HV, IVR | How richly the option is priced: implied volatility, compared with how much the stock has actually moved, and with its own past year (IV Rank). IVR needs about 60 days of history, which the app collects by itself while it is open; until then it shows how many days it has. |
| Δ | Delta: roughly the chance the option ends in the money. 0.20 is about a 1-in-5 chance. |
| PoP | Probability of profit. |
| OI, Spr% | Open interest and bid/ask spread: how easy it is to trade. |

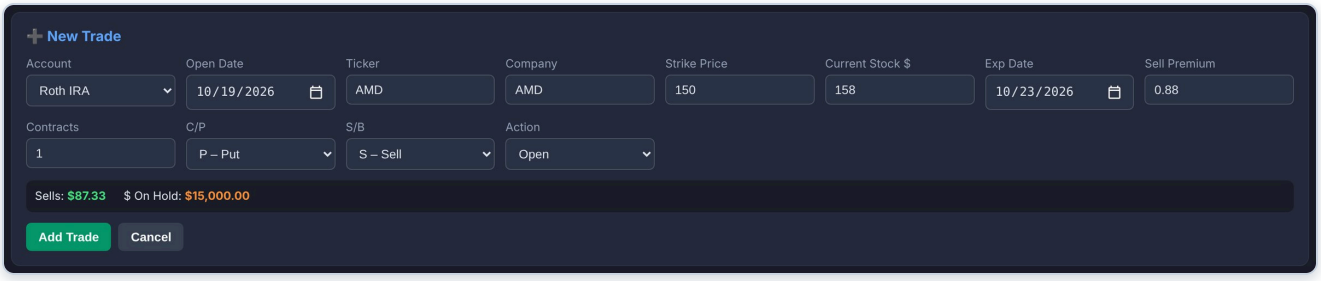
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| Column | Meaning |
|---|---|
| P/E | Price to earnings ratio of the stock. |
| Free, Basis, vs Basis | For covered calls: free lots, your cost basis, and how far the strike is above it. |
| B/E | Break-even price. |
| **+ Log** | Opens the New Trade window on the Options tab, already filled in. Check it and click **Add Trade**. |




*Hover over a Score to see how it was worked out*

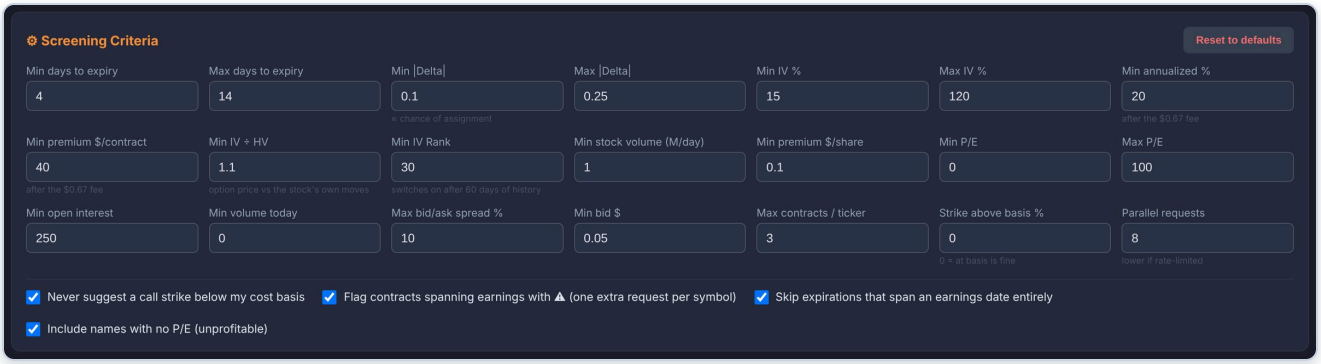
The Score adds up four things: **Edge** (35%): is the option priced richly for this stock; **Cushion** (25%): how far the price must move before it hurts; **Return** (25%): the yearly return after the fee; and **Liquidity** (15%): how easy it is to get in and out.




*+ Log fills in the New Trade window for you*

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## Screening criteria

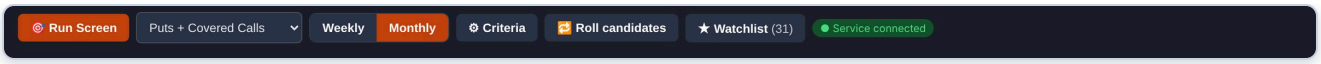



*All the Screener rules*

Click ⚙️ **Criteria** to see and change every rule. **Weekly** and **Monthly** fill them in for you; change any box to make your own. **Reset to defaults** puts them back.

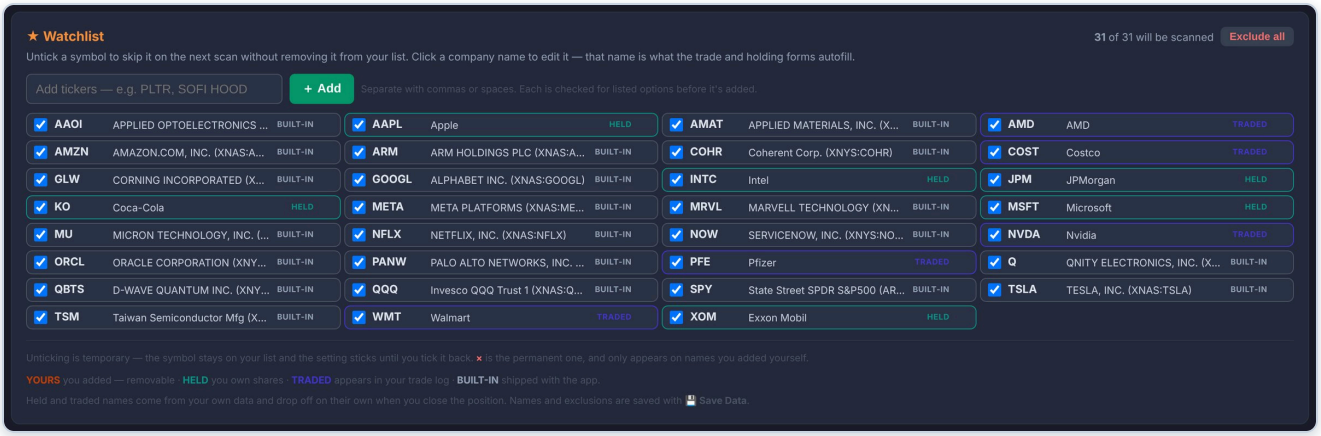
| Rule | What it means |
|---|---|
| Min / Max days to expiry | How soon the option must expire. |
| Min / Max \|Delta\| | How likely it is to end in the money. Lower is safer. |
| Min / Max IV % | How richly priced the option must be. |
| Min annualized % | The lowest yearly return to show, after the fee. |
| Min premium $/contract, Min premium $/share | Skip options that pay too little. |
| Min IV ÷ HV | Option price compared with how the stock actually moves. Above 1 means the option is rich. |
| Min IV Rank | Only used once 60 days of history exist. |
| Min stock volume (M/day) | Skip thinly traded stocks. |
| Min / Max P/E | Company valuation limits. |
| Min open interest, Min volume today, Max bid/ask spread %, Min bid $ | Skip contracts that are hard to trade at a fair price. |
| Max contracts / ticker | How many results per stock at most. |
| Strike above basis % | For covered calls: how far above your cost the strike must be. |
| Parallel requests | How many tickers to check at once. Leave it as it is. |
| Never suggest a call strike below my cost basis | Protects you from selling shares at a loss. |
| Flag contracts spanning earnings with ⚠ | Marks options that expire after an earnings report. |
| Skip expirations that span an earnings date entirely | Hides them instead. |
| Include names with no P/E (unprofitable) | Untick to skip companies that lose money. |

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*Monthly lit up: the Monthly rules are in use*

## Your Screener watchlist

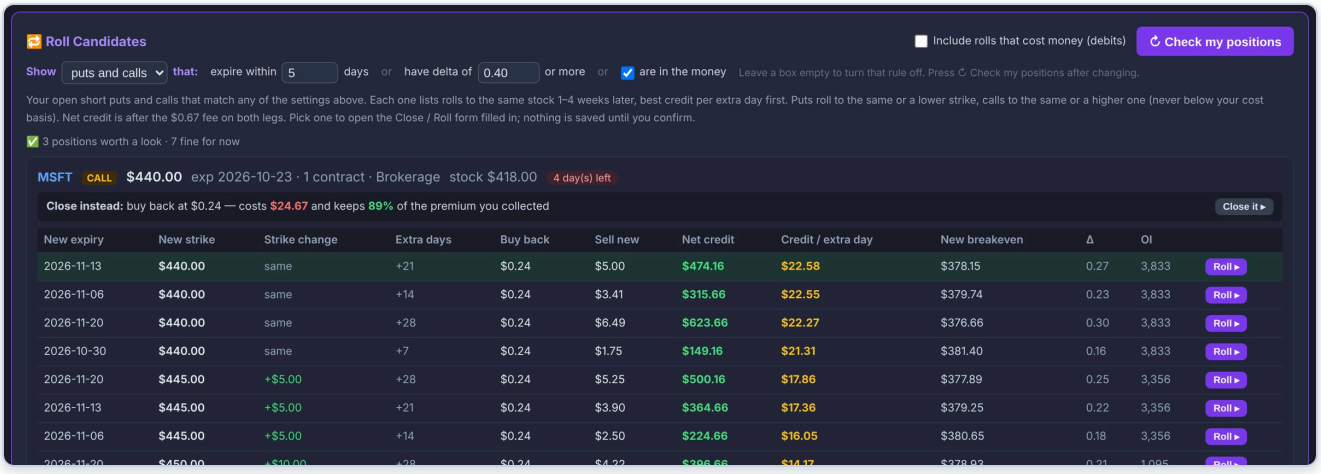



*The Screener watchlist*

The Screener checks every ticked name in this list.

- Type tickers in the box (for example `PLTR, SOFI`) and click **+ Add**.
- **Untick** a name to skip it on the next run without removing it. **Include all** / **Exclude all** tick or untick them all.
- **×** removes a name you added yourself.
- The tags show where a name came from: **YOURS** (you added it), **HELD** (you own shares), **TRADED** (in your trade log), **BUILT-IN** (comes with the app).
- Click a company name to edit it. That name is what the trade and holding forms fill in.

## Roll candidates




*Roll candidates for options close to expiry*

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Click 🔁 **Roll candidates** to get ideas for options you already hold.

1. In the line at the top, choose **Show** puts and calls, puts only or calls only, and which positions to check: those that **expire within** a number of days, **have delta of** a number **or more**, or **are in the money**. A position shows if it matches any rule that is on. Leave a box empty, or untick in the money, to turn that rule off.
2. Tick **Include rolls that cost money (debits)** if you also want to see rolls that cost you money.
3. Click ↻ **Check my positions**.

Each position shows a **Close instead** line: what buying it back would cost, and how much of the premium you would keep, with a **Close it ▸** button. Below it is a table of rolls to the same stock 1 to 4 weeks later, the best **credit per extra day** first:

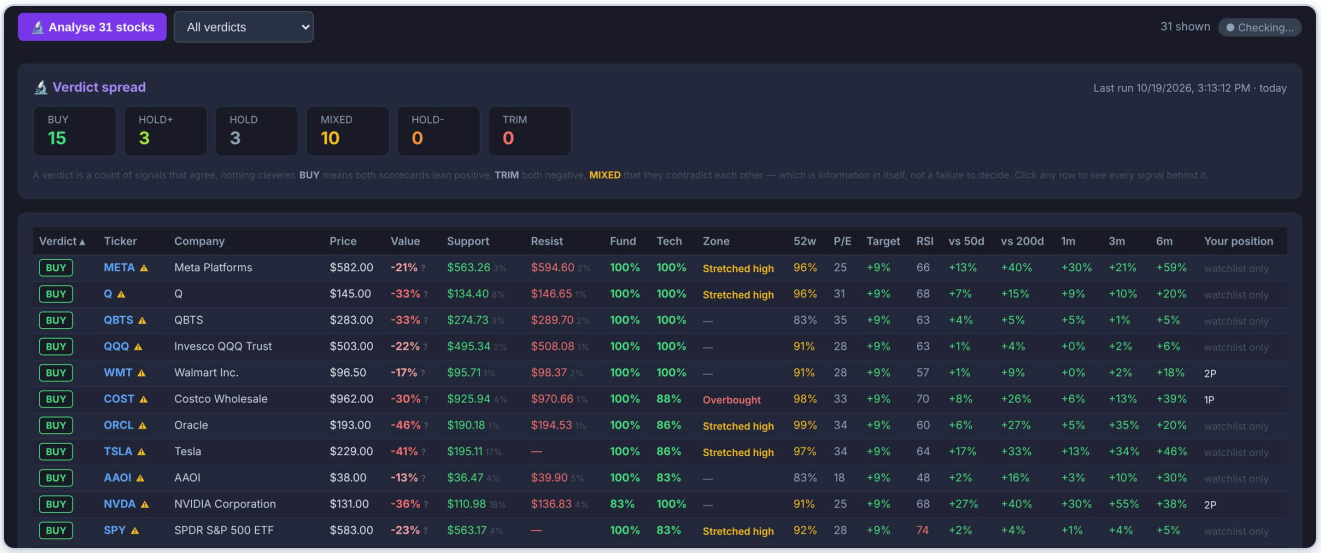
| Column | Meaning |
|---|---|
| New expiry, New strike, Strike change | The replacement option. |
| Extra days | How much longer you would hold it. |
| Buy back, Sell new | Price to close the old one, and premium for the new one. |
| Net credit | What you collect overall for one contract. |
| Credit / extra day | Net credit divided by extra days. Higher is better. |
| New breakeven, Δ, OI | Break-even after the roll, delta and open interest of the new option. |

Click **Roll ▸** on a row to open the Close / Roll window already filled in (Chapter 6). Nothing is saved until you click **Confirm Roll**.

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# 11. The Analysis tab

Analysis gives a quick health check of every stock you hold or watch, based on the company's numbers and its price chart.




*The Analysis tab after a run*

- Click 🔬 **Analyse N stocks** to start. **✕ Cancel** stops a run. Use the drop-down to show only one verdict.
- The **Verdict spread** cards count how many stocks got each verdict.

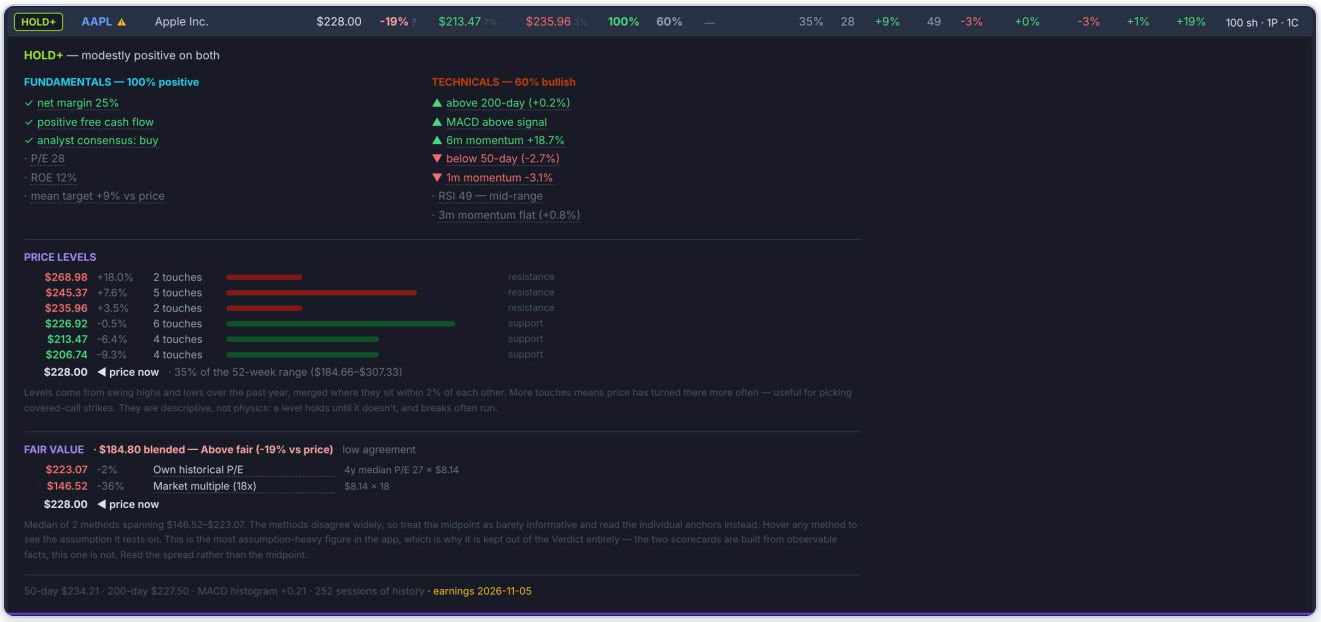
| Verdict | Meaning |
|---|---|
| BUY | The business numbers and the price trend both look good. |
| HOLD+ | Mostly positive. |
| HOLD | Neutral. |
| MIXED | The two views disagree. That is information, not a failure. |
| HOLD- | Mostly negative. |
| TRIM | Both views look weak. |

| Column | Meaning |
|---|---|
| Price, Value | Today's price, and how it compares with the fair-value estimate. |
| Support, Resist | Nearby price levels where the stock has turned before. |
| Fund, Tech | Percent of positive signals in the company's numbers (fundamentals) and in the price chart (technicals). |
| Zone | Stretched high, Overbought, Oversold or Stretched low, when the price has moved far. |
| 52w | Where the price sits in its range over the past year. |

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| Column | Meaning |
|---|---|
| P/E, Target | Price to earnings, and the analysts' average target compared with today's price. |
| RSI | A momentum reading from 0 to 100; above 70 is hot, below 30 is cold. |
| vs 50d, vs 200d | Price compared with its 50-day and 200-day averages. |
| 1m, 3m, 6m | Price change over 1, 3 and 6 months. |
| Your position | What you hold: shares (sh), puts (P) and calls (C). |

Click any row to open its details: the signals behind the verdict, **Price Levels** with how many times the price touched each one, and **Fair Value** estimates.



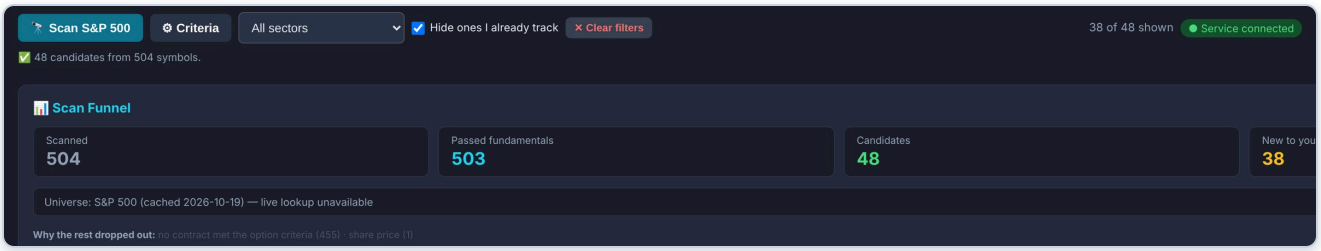

*Details for one stock*

> **Tip:** run Analysis once before using the 🏅 Scorecard's Concentration section; that is where the sectors come from.

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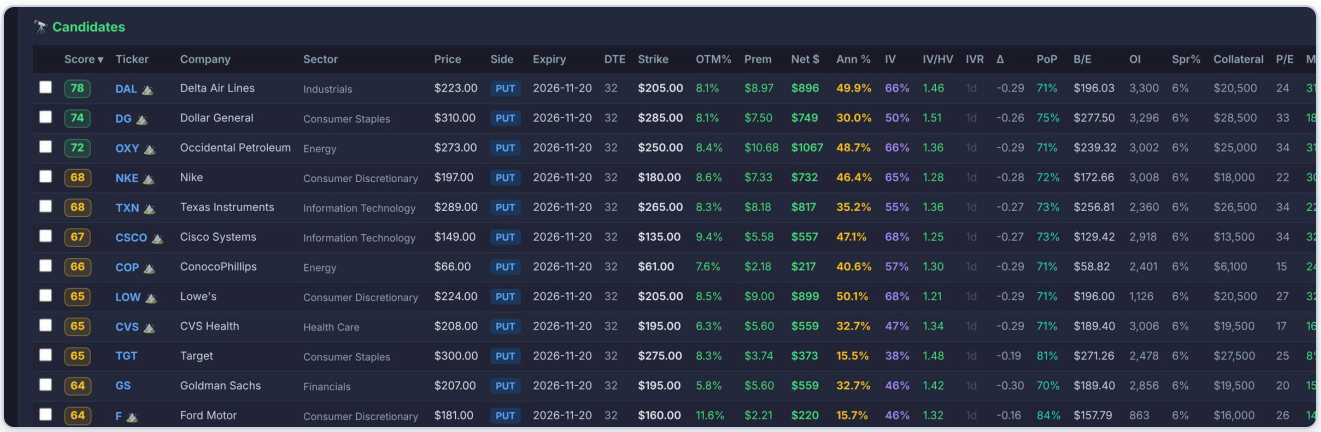
# 12. The Discover tab

Discover looks through all 500 companies in the S&P 500 to find new names worth adding to your watchlist.



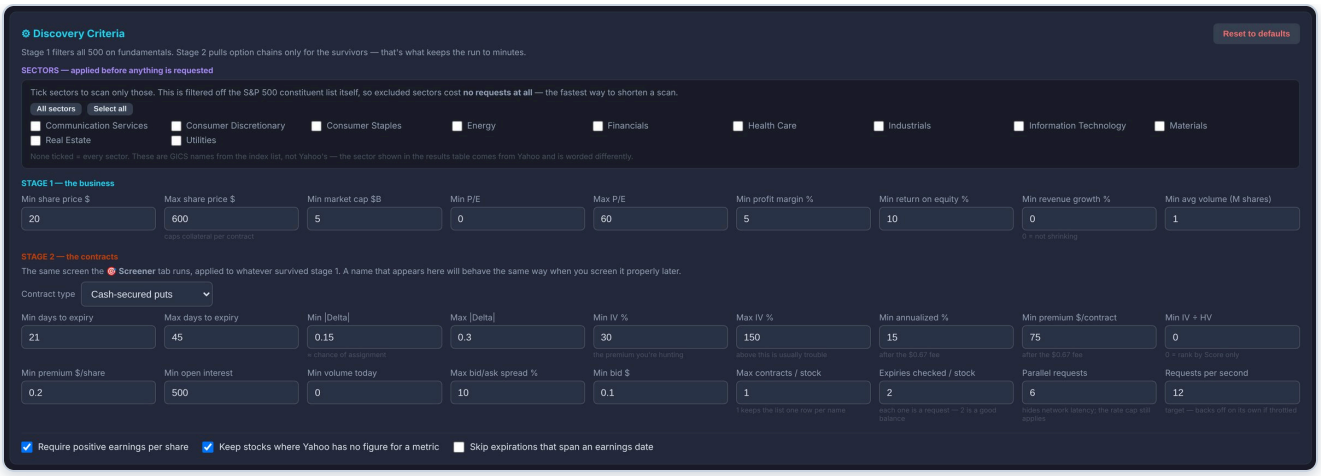

*Discover after a scan*

1. Click ⚙️ **Criteria** to set the rules (below), or keep the defaults.
2. Click 🔭 **Scan S&P 500**. A full scan takes a few minutes. **✕ Cancel scan** stops it.
3. Read the **Scan Funnel**: how many were scanned, how many passed the business rules, how many had a suitable option, and how many are **New to you**.
4. Use the sector drop-down, **Hide ones I already track** and **✕ Clear filters** to narrow the list.
5. Tick the names you like and click **+ Add N to watchlist**. The Screener will then check them on every run.




*Candidates found by the scan*

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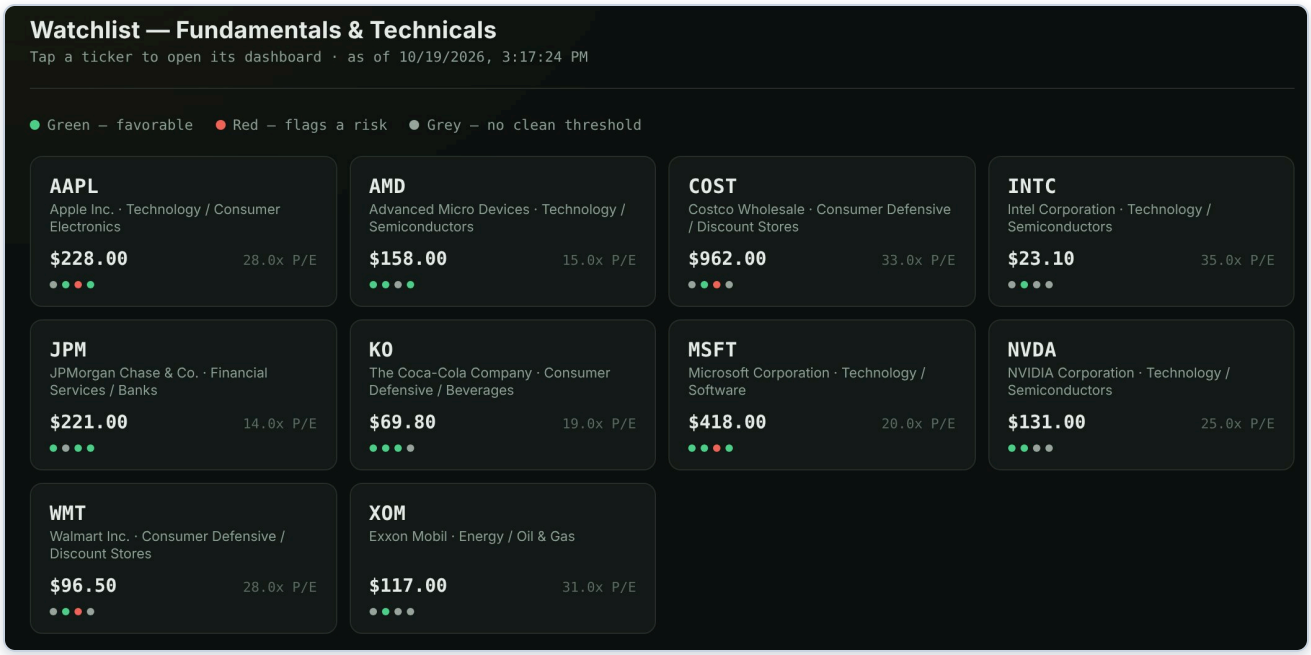



*Discovery criteria*

The criteria have three parts: **Sectors** (tick some to scan only those; none ticked means all), **Stage 1 — the business** (share price, company size, P/E, profit margin, return on equity, revenue growth, trading volume) and **Stage 2 — the contracts** (the same option rules as the Screener). **Reset to defaults** puts them back.

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# 13. The Watchlist tab




*A card for each stock you hold or trade*

The Watchlist shows a card for each stock you hold or have traded, with its price and P/E. The coloured dots summarise the company's health: **green** is favourable, **red** flags a risk, **grey** has no clear answer.

Click a card to open its dashboard. Hover over a box for the reasoning behind its colour. **← All tickers** goes back.

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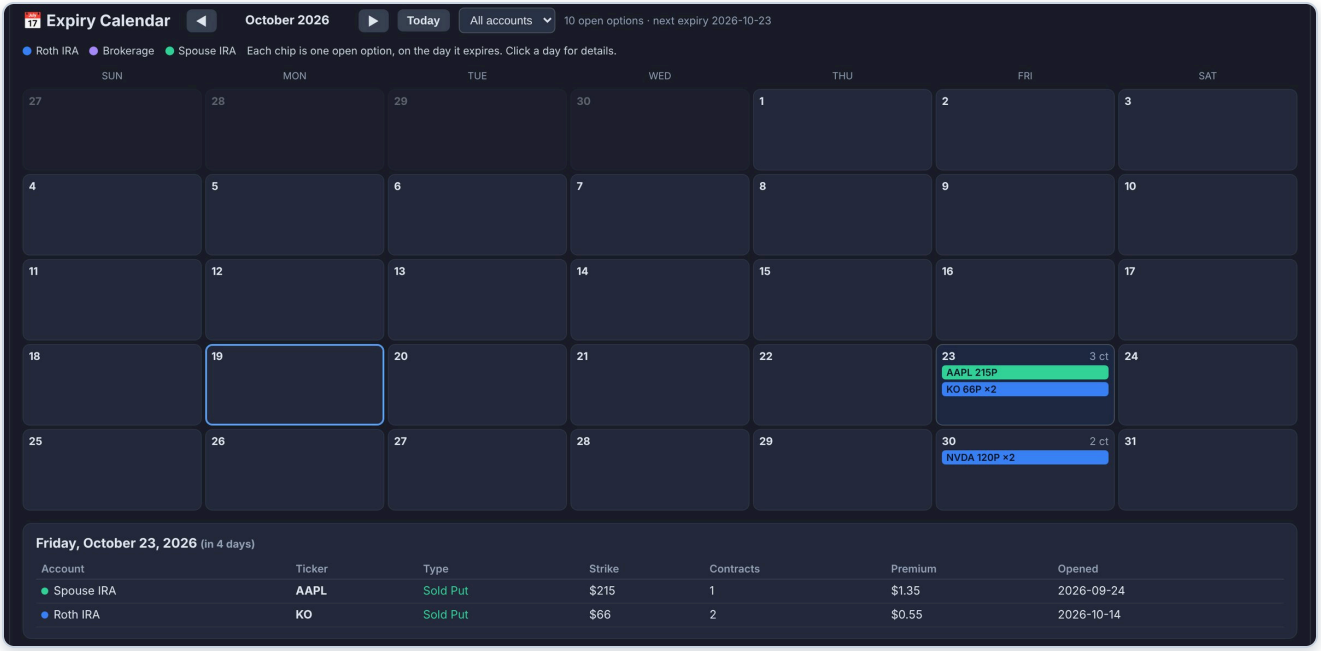



*The dashboard for one stock*

| Box | Meaning |
|---|---|
| P/E ratio | Price compared with yearly profit per share. |
| EPS (TTM) | Profit per share over the last 12 months. |
| Net profit margin | Cents of profit from each dollar of sales. |
| Debt / Equity | How much the company borrows compared with what it owns. |
| Revenue, Market cap | Yearly sales and the company's total value. |
| Beta | How much the stock moves compared with the market. Below 1 is calmer. |

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# 14. The Calendar tab




*The expiry calendar, with one day clicked*

The Calendar shows each open option on the day it expires, coloured by account.

- ◀ and ▶ change the month; **Today** comes back to this month.
- The drop-down shows **All accounts** or one account.
- Each chip is one open option, for example "KO 66P ×2" (KO, $66 put, 2 contracts). The corner of a day shows the total contracts ("3 ct").
- **Click a day** to list its trades underneath: account, ticker, type, strike, contracts, premium and the day it was opened.

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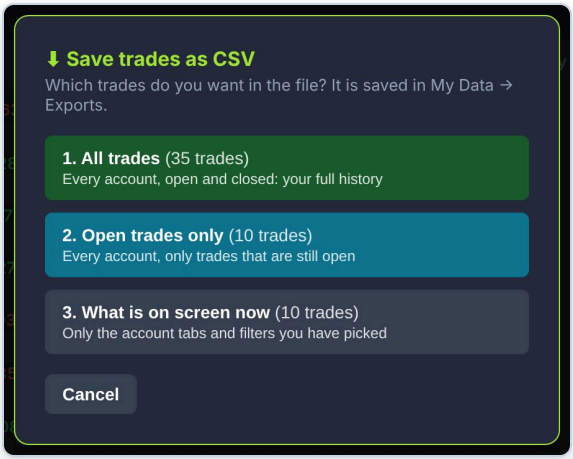



# Part 3. Tools, settings and your information

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# 15. Saving, exporting and bringing in data

## ⬇️ CSV




*⬇️ CSV asks which trades to save*

Saves your option trades as a spreadsheet file that opens in Excel. It asks which trades: **1** all trades, open and closed; **2** open trades only; or **3** what is on screen now (after your filters).

## 📊 Excel

Saves a formatted Excel workbook with a sheet for each account.

Both are saved in **My Data → Exports** inside your app folder, and a message says where.

## 💾 Save Data and 📂 Load Data

💾 **Save Data** makes a backup of everything: trades, stocks and watchlist. A message shows where it was saved: **My Data → Backups**, in a file named with today's date. The newest 30 are kept.

> **Tip:** to be extra safe, copy the newest backup to a USB stick, email it to yourself, or keep your app folder in OneDrive or Google Drive.

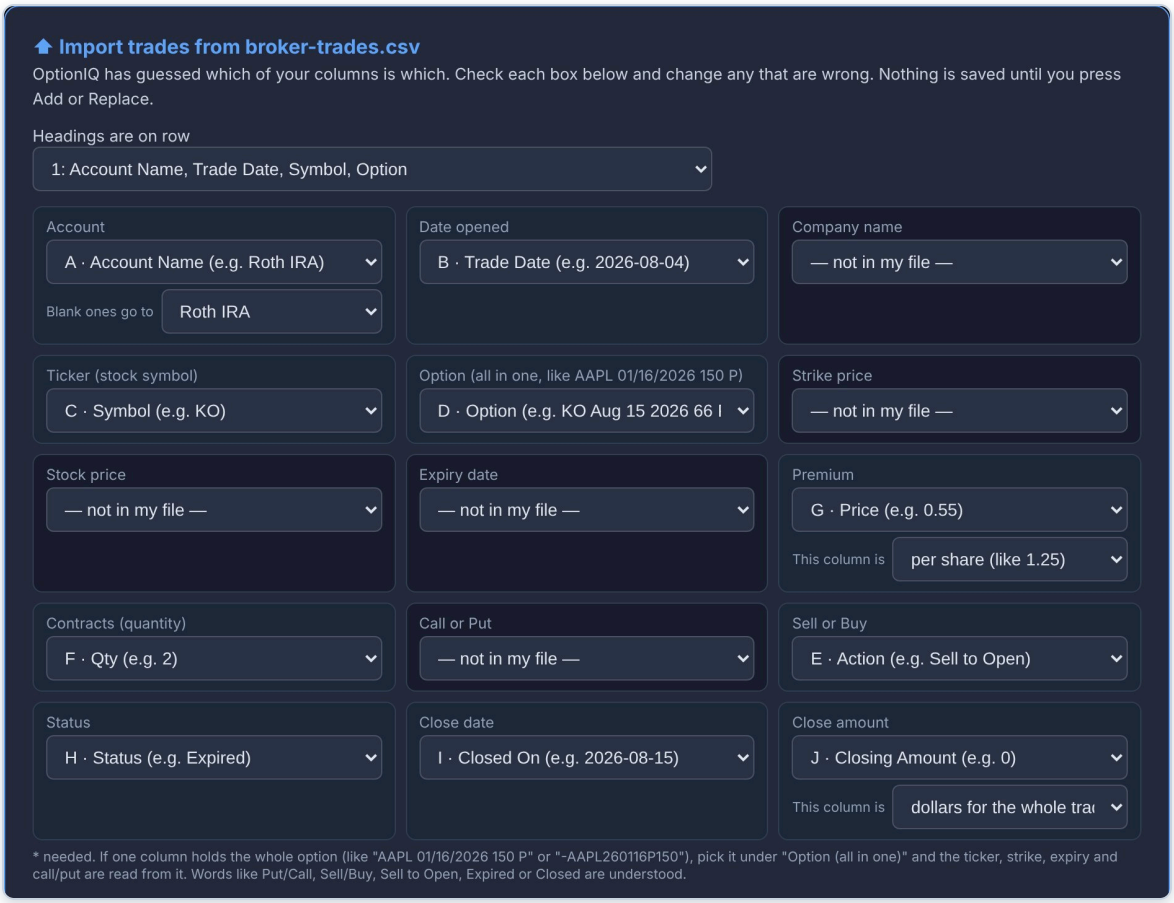
📂 **Load Data** brings back a backup made by 💾 Save Data, or by the browser version (Options Trade Logger). Any account name in the file that you don't have yet is added for you.

## ⬆️ Import

Brings in past option trades from a spreadsheet: an Excel file (.xlsx or .xlsm) or a file saved as CSV (.csv, .txt or .tsv). Open and closed trades both come in. Your spreadsheet can have its own layout, for example a download from your broker: you tell OptionIQ which column is which.

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1. Click ⬆ **Import** and pick your file.
2. The **Import trades** window opens. OptionIQ has already guessed which of your columns is which. Check each box and fix any wrong guess (below).
3. Look at the **Preview** at the bottom: the first 8 trades exactly as they will be saved, and any rows that will be left out.
4. Click ➕ **Add N to my trades**. Nothing is saved before you do.
5. Check the trades on 📋 Options. Importing the same file twice gives you every trade twice.



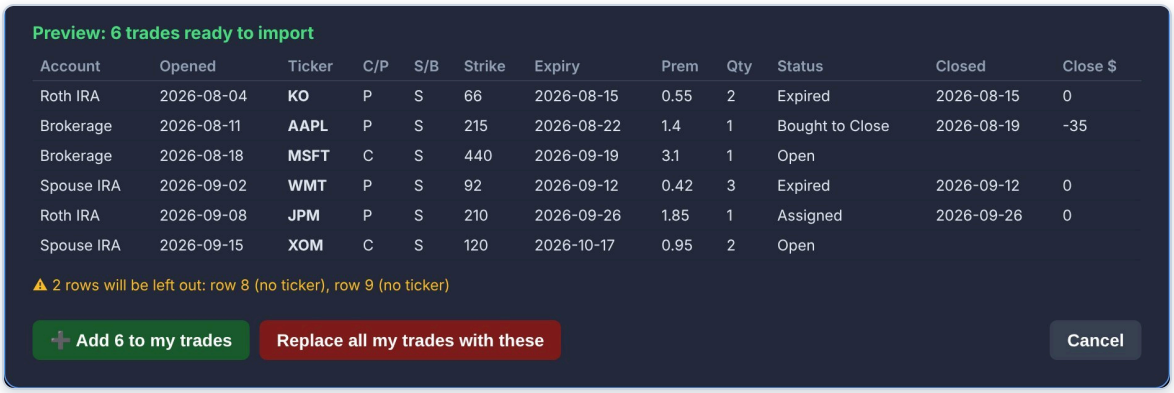

*The Import window: one box for each piece of a trade*

| Part | What it does |
|---|---|
| Sheet | Only for an Excel file with more than one sheet: pick the sheet that holds your trades. OptionIQ picks the most likely one for you. |
| Headings are on row | The row that holds your column headings. Change it if your file has a title or notes above the headings. |
| A box for each field | Account, Date opened, Company name, Ticker, Option (all in one), Strike price, Stock price, Expiry date, Premium, Contracts, Call or Put, Sell or Buy, Status, Close date and Close amount. Each drop-down lists your columns by letter, with an example from your file. Pick **— not in my file —** if you don't have that column. |
| Blank ones go to | The account used for rows that have no account name. |

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| Part | What it does |
|---|---|
| Option (all in one) | Use this if one column holds the whole option, like "AAPL 01/16/2026 150 P". OptionIQ then reads the ticker, strike, expiry and call or put from it. |
| This column is (Premium) | Say whether your premium column is **per share** (like 1.25) or **dollars for the whole trade** (like 125). |
| This column is (Close amount) | The same choice for the close amount. |

In the example above, OptionIQ guessed the **Status** box wrong (it picked the Action column), so it was changed to **H · Status**. Words your broker uses, like Put or Call, Sell or Buy, Sell to Open, Expired or Closed, are understood. Totals rows are skipped.




*The Preview, the rows left out, and the Add and Replace buttons*

- **Preview** shows the first 8 trades as they will be saved. If something looks wrong, change a box above and the preview updates at once.
- A yellow ⚠ line lists any rows that will be left out, with the reason, for example "row 8 (no ticker)".
- ➕ **Add N to my trades** adds the trades to the ones you already have.
- **Replace all my trades with these** removes all your option trades and keeps only the ones from this file. The app asks you to confirm first.
- **Cancel** closes the window. Nothing is saved.

If your file has account names that aren't in OptionIQ yet, the app lists them. Press **OK** to create them, or **Cancel** to go back and pick a different Account column.

OptionIQ remembers your choices. The next time you import a file laid out the same way, the boxes are already filled in, and the window says "These are the column choices you used last time".

> **Tip:** an old Excel file (.xls) can't be read. Open it in Excel, choose **File → Save As → Excel Workbook (.xlsx)**, and import the new file. On a Mac in Numbers, use **File → Export To → Excel** or **CSV**.

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**OptionIQ Sample Import.xlsx** still works as a ready-made layout: it holds 8 made-up trades, and you can type your own trades over them. A file made by ⬇️ CSV imports back too.

## Import or Load Data: which one?

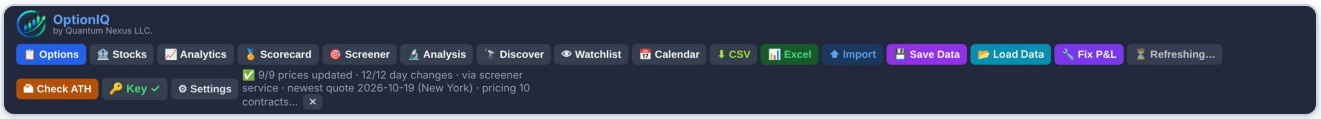
| | 📂 Load Data | ⬆ Import |
|---|---|---|
| File it takes | The .json backup made by 💾 Save Data | A spreadsheet (.xlsx, .xlsm, .csv, .txt, .tsv) |
| What comes in | Option trades, stocks and watchlist | Option trades only |
| To add | Press **OK**: adds only what you don't already have | Click ➕ **Add N to my trades**: adds every row |
| To replace | Press **Cancel**: **replaces all your data** with the backup | Click **Replace all my trades with these**, then confirm |
| Use it for | Restoring a backup, or moving to a new computer | Bringing in past trades from a spreadsheet |

> **Careful:** in the 📂 Load Data pop-up, **Cancel does not mean stop. It means replace everything.** To add, press **OK**. Before loading or replacing anything, press 💾 Save Data so you can go back.

## 🔧 Fix P&L

Recalculates the Net P&L of every trade. The app asks "Recalculate all Net P&L?" first. Use it if a total looks wrong, for example after editing many rows.

## 🔄 Prices




*The price status line, after 🔄 Prices*

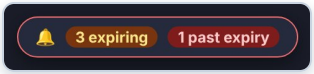
Fetches the latest stock prices (with your Finnhub key) and option prices (through the Screener's helper). While it works, the button reads **Refreshing...**. A status line under the buttons says how many prices were updated; click its ✕ to hide it.

## 🏔️ Check ATH

Looks up the all-time highs of SPY and QQQ, shown next to the account tabs.

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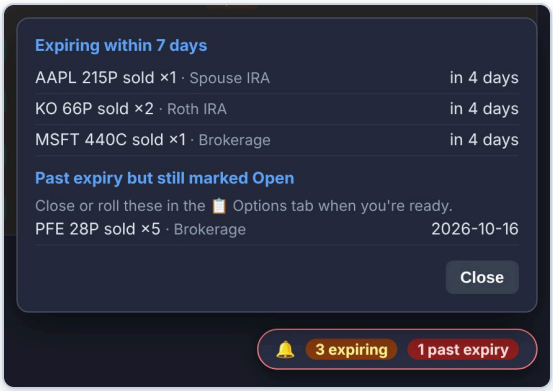
# 16. Reminders




*The 🔔 reminder button in the bottom-right corner*

The 🔔 button sits in the bottom-right corner whenever something needs your attention. Click it to see the list.

- **"expiring"**: open options that expire within 7 days (you can change the number of days in ⚙️ Settings).
- **"past expiry"**: options whose expiry date has passed but are still marked Open. The app never changes them on its own; close or roll them yourself.
- **"Backup due"**: your last backup is more than a week old. Click 💾 **Back up now** right there.

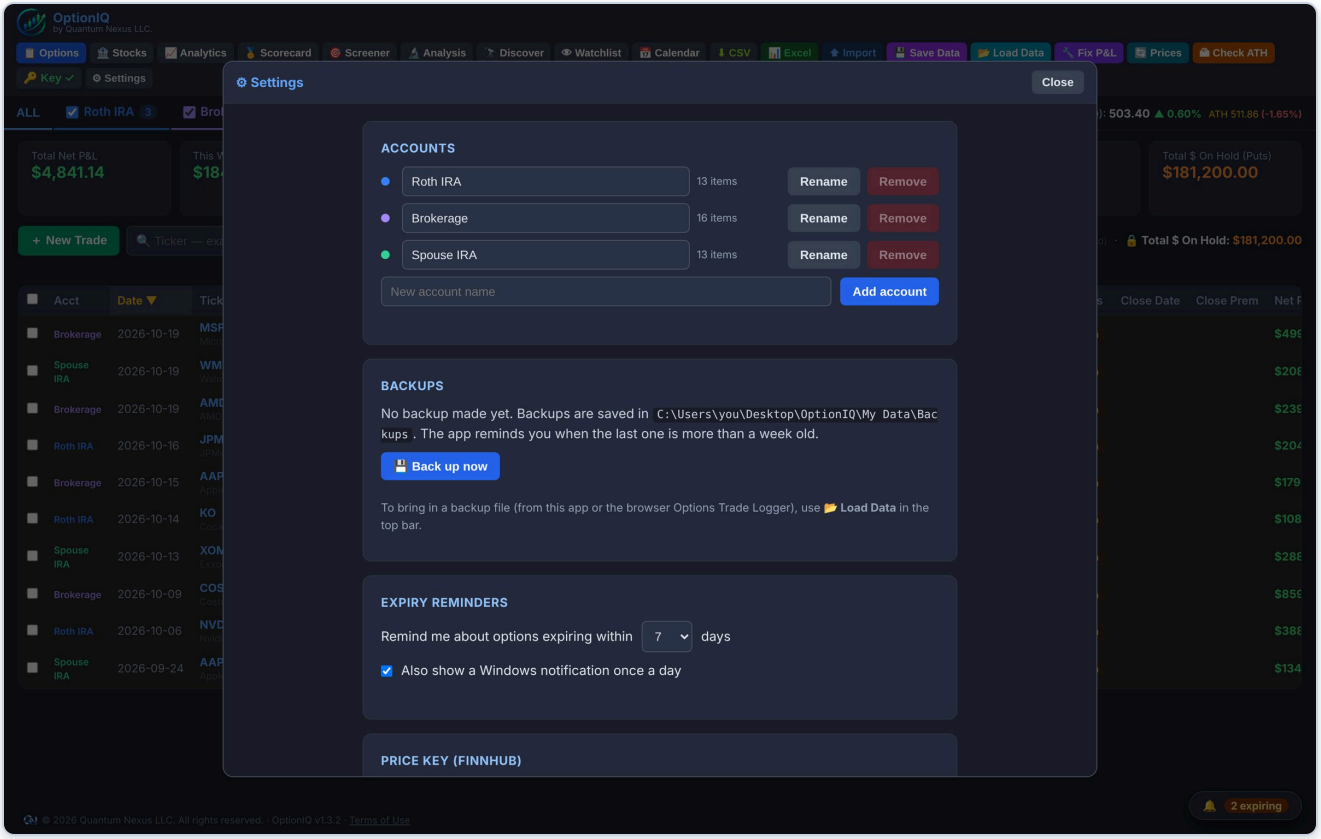



*The reminder list, opened*

While the app is open, Windows (or your Mac) also shows a small pop-up once a day about options expiring soon.

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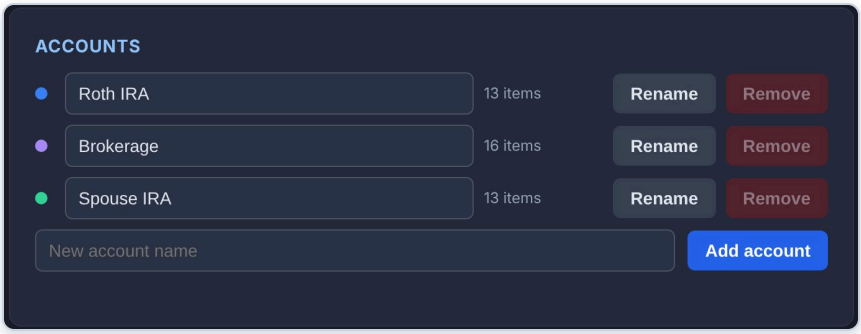
# 17. Settings




*⚙️ Settings opens in a window over the app. Click Close at the top right when done.*

⚙️ Settings has six parts.

## Accounts

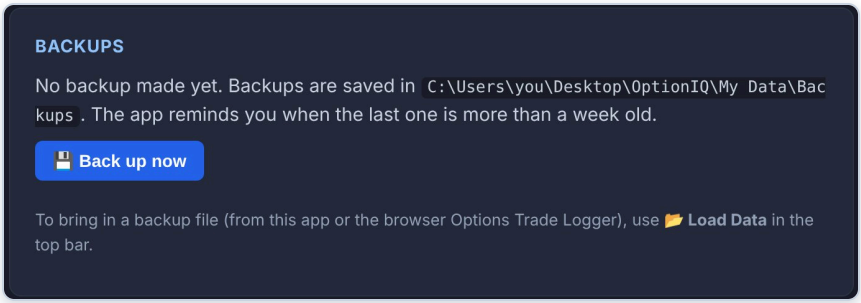



*Accounts*

- **Rename** an account: type the new name and click Rename. Its trades follow the new name.
- **Remove** works only for an account with no trades or holdings ("0 items").
- Type a name in **New account name** and click **Add account** to add one.

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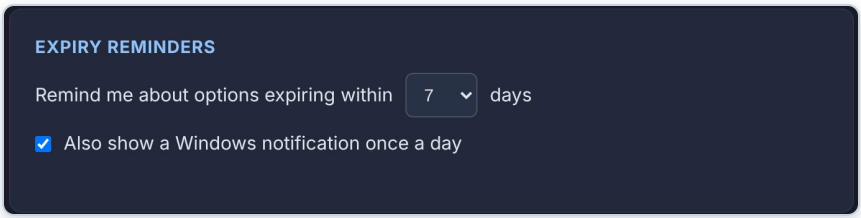
## Backups




*Backups*

Shows when you last backed up and where backups are saved. 💾 **Back up now** makes one. The app reminds you when the last one is more than a week old.

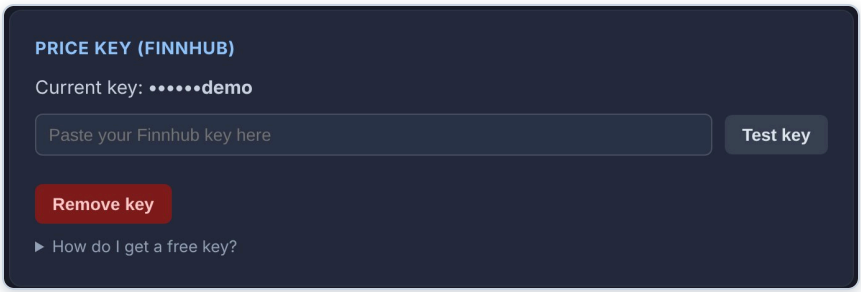
## Expiry reminders




*Expiry reminders*

Choose how many days ahead (1 to 30) to be reminded of expiring options, and whether to also show a Windows (or Mac) notification once a day.

## Price key (Finnhub)

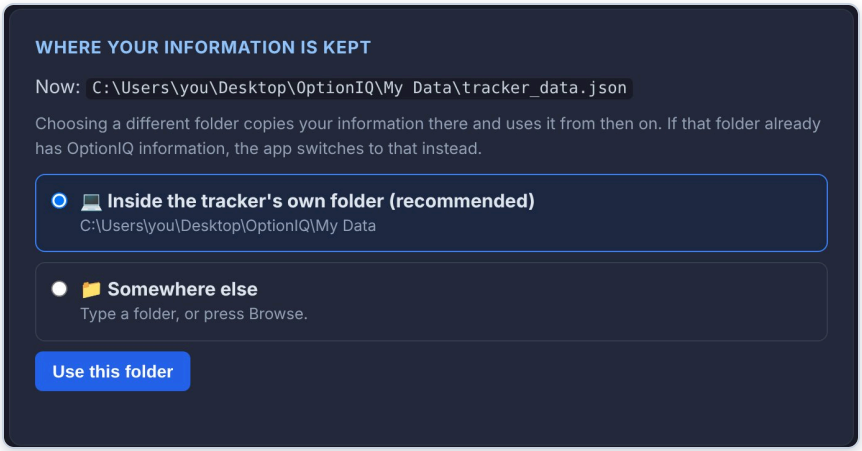



*Price key*

Shows the end of the key you saved. Paste a new key and click **Test key** to change it, or click **Remove key**. **How do I get a free key?** opens the steps from Chapter 4.

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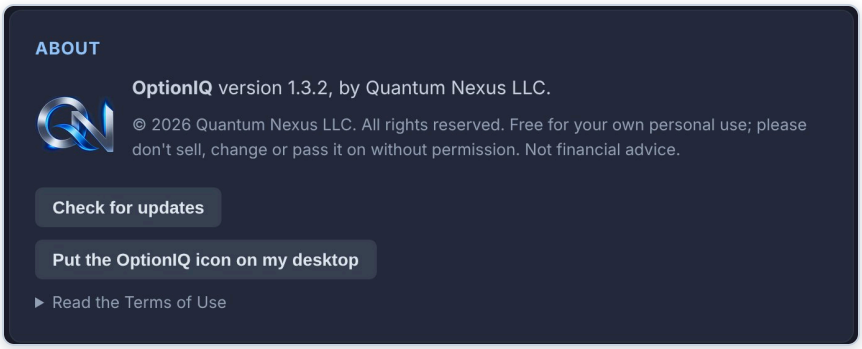
## Where your information is kept




*Where your information is kept*

Shows the file your information is in now. Choose **Inside the tracker's own folder (recommended)**, or **Somewhere else** (for example a OneDrive or Google Drive folder; type it or click **Browse**), then click **Use this folder**. The app copies your information there and uses it from then on. If that folder already has OptionIQ information, the app switches to that instead.

## About

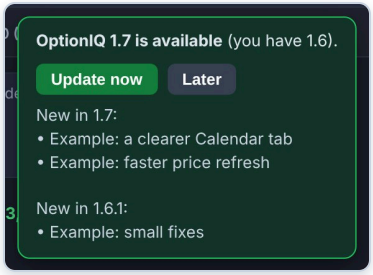



*About*

Shows your version. **Check for updates** looks for a new version right now. **Put the OptionIQ icon on my desktop** puts the icon back if you deleted it. **Read the Terms of Use** shows the terms.

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# 18. Updates




*A new version is ready*

The app looks for a new version when it starts and every 6 hours. When one is ready, a green note appears at the top right. The **Update now** and **Later** buttons are at the top, and under them a list of what's new in every version since the one you have. If the list is long, it scrolls.

1. Click **Update now**, then **OK**.
2. The app first backs up your information, then downloads the new version. The note shows how far along it is.
3. The app closes and opens again by itself, in the same folder. The footer shows the new version number.

Your trades, stocks, settings and price key stay exactly as they were. **Later** hides the note until the next start.

If the update can't finish (for example the internet drops), the note turns red and nothing is changed. Click **Try again**, or **Download it myself** to get the new zip and extract it over your app folder. On Windows, choose **Replace** when asked about files that already exist. On a Mac, move your **My Data** and **Settings** folders into the new OptionIQ folder.

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# 19. The OptionIQ phone app

The phone app is a small companion to OptionIQ on your computer. Use it to see your open trades, check what expires soon, log a new trade, close or roll a trade, and add a stock to your watchlist while you are away from your computer. It works on iPhone and Android.

It needs two things: OptionIQ 1.6 or newer on your computer, and your **My Data** folder kept in **OneDrive** (⚙️ Settings → Where your information is kept). Google Drive and Dropbox are planned for later.

## How the phone and computer stay in step

Your computer stays in charge of your records.

1. Every time your information changes, OptionIQ on the computer writes a small **phone copy** in **My Data → Phone**. OneDrive carries it to the cloud.
2. The phone reads that copy. It never changes your main records.
3. When you add or change something on the phone, the phone leaves a small note in **My Data → Phone → inbox**. The next time OptionIQ is open on your computer, it reads the note, adds the change with its own sums, and shows you what it added.

OneDrive can take a few minutes to carry files between the phone and the computer. Until the computer has added a change, the phone shows **Waiting for computer** next to it.

## Installing it on your phone

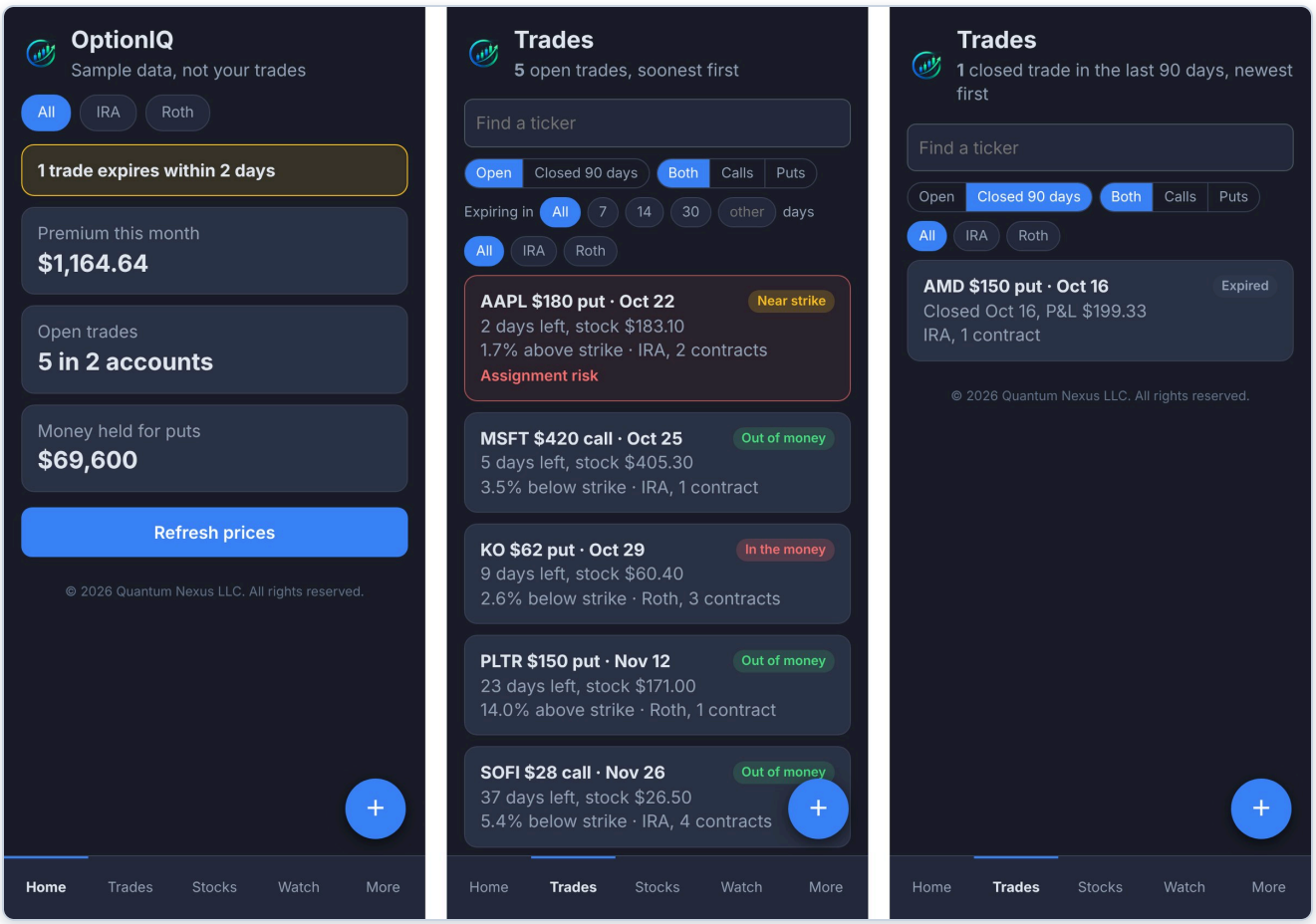
1. On your phone, open **https://skjaggi.github.io/optioniq-updates/phone/**. Use **Safari** on an iPhone, or **Chrome** on Android.
2. iPhone: tap the ··· button (three dots) at the bottom right of Safari, tap **Share**, then scroll down and tap **Add to Home Screen**, then **Add**. On older iPhones the **Share** button (a square with an arrow) is right in the bottom bar, so you can skip the three dots.
3. Android: tap the ⋮ menu at the top right of Chrome, then **Add to Home screen** or **Install app**.
4. Open OptionIQ from the new icon on your home screen. Read the Terms of Use, tick the box, and tap **Continue**.

The app opens with **sample data** so you can look around. To see your own trades, go to **More**, tap **Change**, choose **OneDrive** and sign in with your Microsoft account. Then tap **Choose folder** and pick your OptionIQ **My Data** folder.

If the phone says "OptionIQ on your computer hasn't made its phone copy yet", update OptionIQ on the computer to 1.6 or newer, open it once, wait a few minutes for OneDrive, and try again. If it says "Couldn't reach OneDrive ... 404" right after that, OneDrive has not uploaded the phone copy yet: wait a few minutes and choose the folder again.

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## The five tabs



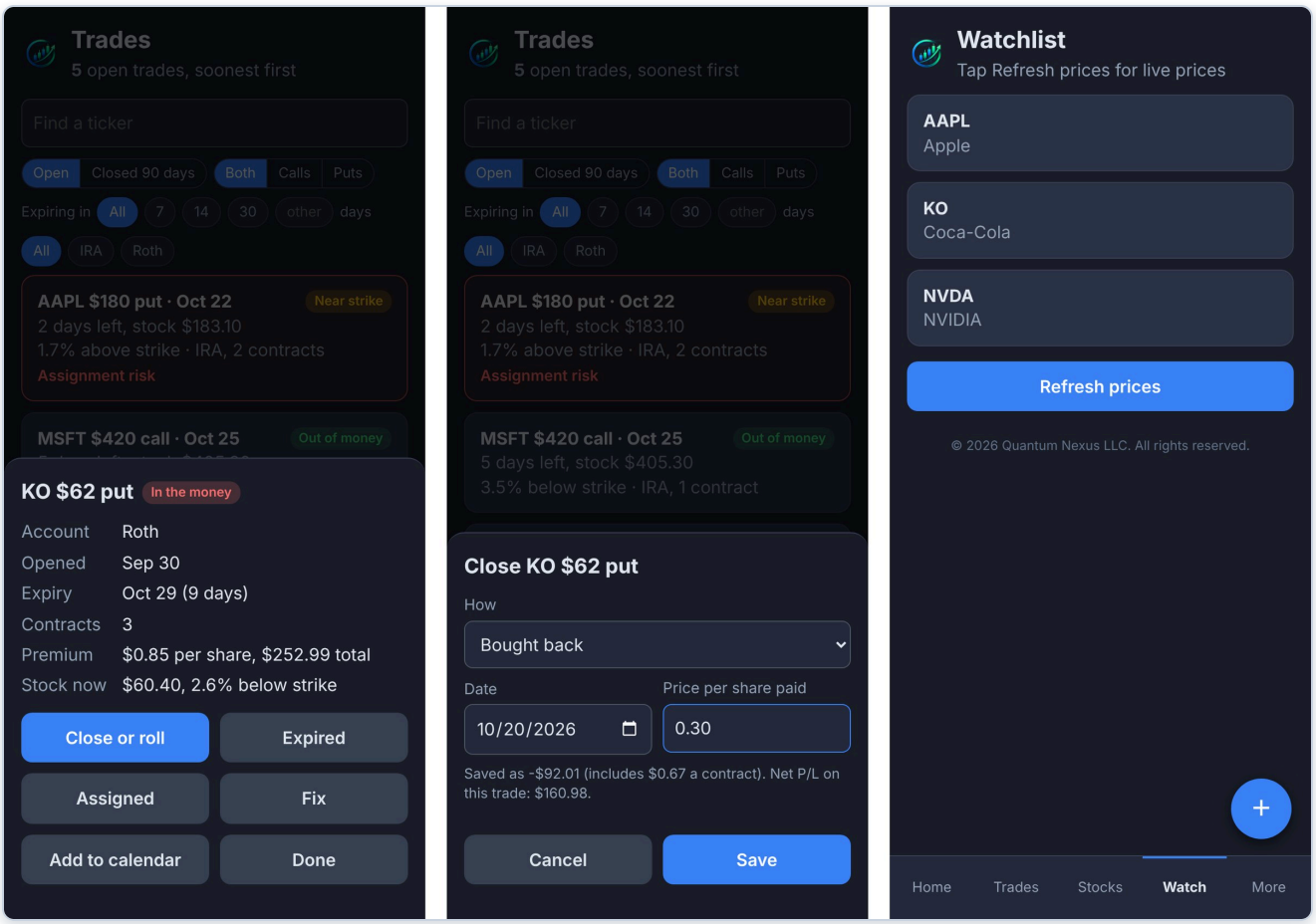

*Home, Trades (Open) and Trades (Closed, 90 days) on the phone*

| Tab | What it shows |
|---|---|
| **Home** | Trades that expire within 2 days, and the same eight summary boxes as the top of the computer's Options tab, with its own **Week |
| **Trades** | Tap **Open** or **Closed 90 days**, and **Both**, **Calls** or **Puts**. The line under the title counts what is shown, for example *6 open puts expiring within 7 days*. On Open, the **Expiring in** buttons (**All**, **7**, **14**, **30**, or type your own number of days) narrow the list. Each card shows the ticker, strike, type and expiry date, for example *KO $62 put · Oct 29*, plus days left and how near the stock is to the strike. |
| **Stocks** | The shares you own. Stock buys and sells are entered on the computer. |
| **Watch** | Your watchlist with prices. Tap **+** to add a stock; it is added to the watchlist on your computer too. |
| **More** | Where your data comes from, the near-strike warning (3% to start), Face ID or passcode to open, and the Terms of Use. |

The account buttons (**All** and each account name) pick which accounts are shown. The **+** button logs a new trade on Home and Trades, adds a stock on Watch, and is hidden on Stocks and More.

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## Closing, rolling and fixing a trade



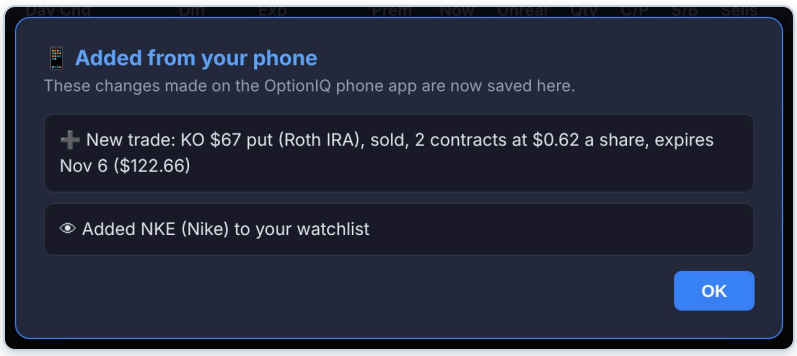

*A trade, the Close form with a price per share, and the Watchlist*

Tap a trade to see its details.

| Button | What it does |
|---|---|
| **Close or roll** | Choose how it ended (**Bought back**, or **Rolled**), the date, and the **price per share** with no minus sign, just like on the computer. The line under it shows what will be saved and the trade's net profit. For a roll, also fill in the new expiry, strike and premium. |
| **Expired** / **Assigned** | One tap to close it that way. An assigned put adds the shares on your computer. |
| **Fix** | Change a detail of an open trade, or of one closed in the last 90 days. |
| **Add to calendar** | Puts the expiry in your phone's calendar with an alert 2 days before. **Add expiries to calendar** on the Trades tab does all of them. |

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## What you see on the computer




*The computer shows exactly what came in from the phone*

When OptionIQ on your computer adds changes from the phone, a window opens in the middle of the screen listing each one in plain words: new trades, closes, rolls, fixes and watchlist additions. Click **OK**. If a change could not be added (for example, the trade was deleted on the computer first), it is listed in amber with the reason.

> **Tip:** your trades stay in your own OneDrive. Quantum Nexus LLC. never receives them.

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# Part 4. Training and help

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# 20. Practice exercises

These exercises use made-up trades, so you can practise without touching your real records. Make a separate practice copy: unzip OptionIQ into a new folder called **OptionIQ Practice**, set it up with any account names, and delete the folder when you are done.

## Exercise 1: Bring in sample trades

1. In your practice copy, click ⬆ **Import** and pick **OptionIQ Sample Import.xlsx**. Check the boxes and the Preview, then click ➕ **Add 8 to my trades**. If it lists account names you don't have, press **OK** to create them.
2. On 📋 Options, open ⚙️ **Filters**, set Status to **All**, and see all 8 trades.
3. Click the **Net P&L** heading to sort by profit. Which trade made the most?

## Exercise 2: Log a cash-secured put

1. Click **+ New Trade**. Pick an account, type `KO`, strike `66`, an expiry date two Fridays from now, premium `0.55`, contracts `2`, **P – Put**, **S – Sell**.
2. Check the line under the form: Sells about $108.66 and $13,200.00 on hold. Click **Add Trade**.
3. Look at the **Total $ On Hold (Puts)** card: it went up by $13,200.

## Exercise 3: Close a trade that expired

1. Find the KO put and click **Close**.
2. Choose **Expired**, leave the price per share empty, and click **Confirm**. The trade moves to Closed with the full premium as profit.

## Exercise 4: A put is assigned, then sell a covered call

1. Log another put, then **Close** it as **Assigned**.
2. Go to 🏦 Stocks: the shares are there with status **Assigned**, at the strike price.
3. Turn on ⚙️ **Filters → Covered Call Opportunity**: the new shares are listed.
4. Go to 🎯 Screener, choose **Covered Calls only** and click 🎯 **Run Screen**. Click **+ Log** on a call above your cost and add it.
5. When the call ends, close it on 📋 Options as **Expired**, or as **Called Away** if your shares were sold.

## Exercise 5: Roll an option

1. On 🎯 Screener, click 🔁 **Roll candidates**, set **expire within** to 7 days and click ↻ **Check my positions**.
2. Pick a row with a good **Credit / extra day** and click **Roll ▸**.

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3. Check the numbers in the window and click **Confirm Roll**.
4. Open 🏅 Scorecard: your roll appears under **Rolled vs. left alone**.

## Exercise 6: Your weekly routine

1. Start the app and click 🔄 **Prices**.
2. Click the 🔔 button. Close or roll anything past expiry.
3. Check 📅 Calendar for the coming week.
4. Run 🎯 Screener (Weekly) and log any trades you place at your broker.
5. Click 💾 **Save Data**.

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# 21. Troubleshooting

| Problem | What to do |
|---|---|
| Nothing opens when I double-click Start OptionIQ | Check there is an **app** folder next to it and that unzipping had finished. Try again and wait 10 seconds. If it still won't start, send the file **OptionIQ startup error.txt** from the app folder to whoever shared the app with you. |
| A blue "Windows protected your PC" box | Click **More info**, then **Run anyway**. |
| Mac: "Start OptionIQ.command" can't be opened | System Settings → Privacy & Security → Open Anyway (Chapter 2). |
| The Screener says the service isn't connected | Click ↻ **Retry**. If that doesn't help, close the app and start it again. |
| Screener, Analysis or Discover are empty on first start | Wait for the blue one-time download message to finish. |
| Prices don't update | Check your internet, then ⚙️ Settings → Price key → **Test key**. |
| Trades seem to be missing | Check the account tabs (all ticked?) and the ⚙️ **Filters** count. Click ✕ **Clear**. |
| A total looks wrong | Click 🔧 **Fix P&L**. |
| An option shows "⏳ expired — still open" | Close it as Expired, Assigned or Called Away. |
| Concentration shows "Unclassified" | Run 🔬 Analysis once. |
| Something else | Send the files **tracker.log** and **screener.log** (on a Mac also start.log) from the **Settings** folder to whoever shared the app with you. They hold no trades and no keys. |

**Where everything is kept.** Your app folder holds **My Data** (your trades, backups and exports) and **Settings** (your choices and price key). To move the app or copy it to a new computer, move or copy the whole folder.

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# 22. Glossary

| Word | Meaning |
|---|---|
| All-time high (ATH) | The highest price an index or stock has ever closed at. |
| Annualized return | A trade's return stretched or shrunk to a one-year rate, so short and long trades can be compared. |
| Assigned | The buyer of your option used it: you bought shares (put) or sold them (call). |
| Break-even | The stock price at which a trade neither makes nor loses money. For a sold put: strike minus premium. |
| Called away | Your shares were sold because a covered call you sold was assigned. |
| Cash-secured put | A put you sell while keeping enough cash to buy the shares. |
| Contract | One option, covering 100 shares. |
| Cost basis | What you paid per share. |
| Covered call | A call you sell on shares you own. |
| Delta (Δ) | Roughly the chance an option ends in the money. |
| DTE | Days to expiry. |
| Expiry | The last day of an option. |
| Implied volatility (IV) | How much movement the option's price expects. Higher IV means higher premium. |
| In the money (ITM) | A put with the stock below the strike, or a call with the stock above it. |
| IV Rank (IVR) | Where today's IV sits within its own past year, from 0 to 100. |
| Net credit | Money received minus money paid, for a roll. |
| Open interest (OI) | How many contracts of that option exist. Higher is easier to trade. |
| Out of the money (OTM) | A put with the stock above the strike, or a call with the stock below it. |
| P/E | Share price divided by yearly profit per share. |
| Premium | The price of an option, per share. |
| Probability of profit (PoP) | The estimated chance the trade makes money. |
| Roll | Buy back an option and sell a new one on the same stock, usually later. |
| Strike | The price the shares would change hands at. |
| Unrealised | Profit you would keep if you closed open trades now. |
| Win rate | The percent of closed trades that made money. |

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Words in A to Z order, with the pages where each one is explained. In the PDF, click a page number to jump there.


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